Contracting authority: European Commission

Next generation: Inspiring Nepal's Youth through Culture and Creativity, Digital and Sports

Annex A.2 – Grant application form – Full application

Budget line: BGUE-B2024-14.020220

EuropeAid/183733/DD/ACT/NP

Deadline for submission[1] of full applications will be indicated in the notification letter

(in order to convert to local time click **here**[2])

Number & title of lot	Lot 3: To support civil society initiatives that equip young women and men in Nepal with the skills and knowledge needed for success in a digital world and job market. (Lot 3 Youth in Digital)
Title of the action	UDAAN (*Unleashing Digital Acceleration and Ambition of Nepali Youth)*
Name of the lead applicant	Youth Innovation Lab
Nationality of the lead applicant[3]	Nepal

Dossier No	

(for official use only)

[1] Online submission via PROSPECT is mandatory for this call for proposals (see section 2.2.2 of the guidelines). In PROSPECT all dates and times are expressed in Brussels time. Applicants should note that the IT support is open from Monday to Friday 08:30 to 18:30 Brussels time (except during European Commission public holidays in Belgium as published in the Official Journal).

[2] An example of a time converter tool available online: http://www.timeanddate.com/worldclock/converter.html

[3] An organisation's statutes must show that it was established under the national law of the country concerned and that the head office is located in an eligible country. Any organisation established in a different country cannot be considered an eligible local organisation. See the footnotes to the guidelines for the call.

NOTICE

If processing your reply to the call for proposals involves the recording and processing of personal data (such as names, contact details and CVs), they will be processed[4] solely for the purposes of the management and monitoring of the calls for proposals and of the contract by the data controller without prejudice to possible transmission to the bodies in charge of monitoring or inspection tasks in application of EU law. In addition, as the contract relates to an external action in Partner Countries outside the EU and as the EU, represented by the European Commission, is acting as contracting authority on behalf and for the benefit of the Partner Countries, transmission of personal data may occur to the Partner Country, solely for the purpose of complying with its obligations under the applicable legislative framework and under the financing agreement concluded between the EU and the Partner Country with regard to this grant award procedure. Details concerning processing of your personal data are available on the privacy statement at https://wikis.ec.europa.eu/display/ExactExternalWiki/Annexes#Annexes-AnnexesA(Ch.2):General [5]

In cases where you are processing personal data in the context of participation to a grant award procedure (e.g. contact details of legal representatives of co-applicants, CVs) and/or of the implementation of a contract you shall accordingly inform the data subjects of the details of the processing and communicate the above mentioned privacy statement to them.

The controller of call for proposals is the head of legal affairs unit of DG International Partnerships

[4] Pursuant to Regulation (EU) 2018/1725 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 23 October 2018 on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data by the Union institutions, bodies, offices and agencies and on the free movement of such data, and repealing Regulation (EC) No 45/2001 and Decision No 1247/2002/EC, OJ L 205 of 21.11.2018, p. 39.

[5] This link will lead you to the "Privacy statement" published in the Practical Guide General Annexes (see Annex a13).

Table of Contents

Full Application Form **4**

1 General information *4*

2 The action *5*

2.1. Description of the action 5

2.1.1. Description (max 13 pages) 5

2.1.2. Methodology (max 5 pages) 18

2.1.3. Indicative action plan for implementing the action (max 4 pages) 23

2.1.4. Sustainability of the action (max 3 pages) 27

2.1.5. Logical Framework 30

2.1.6. Budget, amount requested from the contracting authority and other expected sources of funding 30

2.2. Experience 31

FULL APPLICATION FORM

1 General information

Reference of the call for proposals	*EuropeAid/183733/DD/ACT/NP-3*
[Lot number you are applying to:]	*Lot nº 3*
Number of the proposal[6]	*NDICI CSO/2025/183733-3/9*
Name of the lead applicant	*Youth Innovation Lab*
Title of the action	*UDAAN (Unleashing Digital Acceleration and Ambition of Nepali Youth)*
Location of the action	*Nepal, covering all seven provinces*
Duration of the action	*48 Months*

[6] When the contracting authority has evaluated the concept note it informs the lead applicant of the outcome and allocates a proposal number.

2 The action[7]

2.1. Description of the action

2.1.1. Description (max 13 pages)

(a) Relevance and context analysis

Nepal has a significant demographic advantage, with over 40% of its population under 40. However, youth unemployment remains high at 20.54% (Census, 2021), and more than 2,000 young people migrate abroad daily due to limited job opportunities, inadequate access to quality education, and persistent socio-political and economic barriers. While digital transformation is viewed as a pathway to progress, its benefits remain uneven, with urban centers like Kathmandu having advanced digital infrastructure, but rural and marginalized communities face significant challenges, such as poor internet access, low digital literacy, and limited pathways to digital employment.

Despite national frameworks like the ICT Policy (2015) and the Digital Nepal Framework (2019), local-level implementation remains weak. It often fails to address the specific needs of youth, especially women, indigenous, and marginalized groups. A 2025 YI-Lab assessment found that youth cite a lack of job opportunities (40%), professional networks (23%), and digital skills (16%) as key barriers. The same study highlighted that CSOs face significant capacity gaps in cybersecurity, digital rights, and content creation. These challenges intersect across three core areas: access to digital tools and finance, individual and organizational capacity development, and opportunities for mentorship, innovation, and market access. The current ecosystem lacks the infrastructure, coordination, and localized support to prepare youth and civil society for meaningful participation in the digital economy.

In direct response to these constraints, the proposed action, Unleashing Digital Acceleration and Ambition of Nepali Youth (UDAAN), is a 48-month initiative designed to increase the inclusion of young Nepali women and men in the digital world and job market by advancing digital literacy, upskilling innovation, and future market readiness. UDAAN directly addresses the specific objective of the EuropeAid/183733/DD/ACT/NP call (Lot 3 – Youth in Digital) by equipping youth with the digital skills, tools, and opportunities needed to thrive in a rapidly evolving job market. It also responds to all three priorities of the call: (1) empowering underrepresented youth and women, (2) fostering entrepreneurship and job creation, and (3) strengthening local innovation ecosystems through grassroots initiatives.

Aligned with the global objective of strengthening the European Union's partnership with civil society actors in Nepal as independent agents of good governance and development, UDAAN is led by a consortium of influential civil society organizations, Youth Innovation Lab (YI-Lab), Heifer Project Nepal (HPN), Nepal Applied Mathematics and Informatics Institute for Research (NAAMII), and Women in Animation Nepal (WIA-Nepal). The initiative adopts a youth-centered and civil society-driven approach to inclusive digital transformation. Structured around four interlinked action components—*Pathshala*[8], *Karyashala*[9], *Karmashala*[10], *and Nitishala*[11]—the action holistically addresses barriers faced by youth. *Pathshala* focuses on equipping youth with market-relevant digital skills; *Karyashala* provides dedicated spaces for innovation and creative experimentation; *Karmashala* fosters entrepreneurship and job creation through public-private collaboration; and *Nitishala* strengthens municipal systems and policies to institutionalize innovation and digital governance. Together, these components contribute directly to the expected results of the EU call, including increased youth employability, inclusive digital participation, and youth-led innovation.

The action is designed to mainstream key cross-cutting issues, with a gender-transformative focus to ensure equitable digital participation of young Nepali women and community-based organizations (CBOs), especially those from marginalized, minority, and remote communities. Through targeted interventions and inclusive methodologies, it creates meaningful opportunities for underrepresented groups to engage in the digital economy. The initiative aligns with the EU Gender Action Plan III, particularly Principle 4 (advancing equal participation and leadership) and Principle 6 (promoting opportunities in the green and digital transitions), as well as the EU Action Plan on Human Rights and Democracy.

Grounded in the Human Rights-Based Approach (HRBA), the action applies its five core principles: (i) legality, universality, and indivisibility of human rights, (ii) participation, (iii) non-discrimination, (iv) accountability, and (v) transparency, across all phases of the project cycle. It integrates Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) principles to provide fair access, participation, and benefits for women and youth, including indigenous and excluded groups. Furthermore, gender equality and women's empowerment are

[7] The evaluation committee will refer to information provided in the concept note as regards objectives and the relevance of the action.
[8] *Pathshala* is a Nepali word derived from Sanskrit that means a place of learning.
[9] *Karyashal* is a Nepali word derived from Sanskrit that means a place of work for innovation and experimentation.
[10] *Karmashala* is a Nepali word derived from Sanskrit, meaning a workplace in a professional setting.
[11] *Nithishala* is a Nepali word derived from Sanskrit that means a place for setting policies and guidance.

central to the design: WIA-Nepal leads outreach and mentorship in digital and creative industries; HPN anchors rural youth engagement through innovation hubs embedded in municipalities and agri-cooperatives; NAAMII provides technical leadership in AI and emerging technologies; and YI-Lab integrates digital rights, media literacy, and civic-tech applications.

To ensure synergy and avoid duplication, the action builds on proven models and lessons from EU-supported initiatives such as Nepali Yuwa in Climate Action and Green Growth (theYouthCAN.org)[12] and complements ongoing efforts like GRAPE-II in agri-tech innovation, UNESCO's Media and Information Literacy frameworks, and UNDP's civic engagement programs. It contributes meaningfully to the EU Youth Action Plan 2022–2027 and the Sustainable Development Goals—advancing SDG 4 (Quality Education), SDG 5 (Gender Equality), SDG 8 (Decent Work), SDG 13 (Climate Action), and SDG 16 (Inclusive Governance). By integrating these priorities, the action contributes to addressing Nepal's pressing youth employment challenges and catalyzes long-term systemic transformation, aligning with the calls' objective and priorities.

Target groups and final beneficiaries

This action targets youth aged 16 to 35[13], with a focus on young women and men from marginalized and indigenous communities. Additional target groups include youth organizations, local governments and their elected representatives, startups, academic institutions, and CSOs/CBOs focusing on agri-cooperatives. Final beneficiaries encompass youth and women, including those of rural areas, disadvantaged, ethnic, and minority communities, vulnerable populations, and residents across diverse geographic and economic regions.

The table below shows the needs and constraints of each target group with the proposed intervention to bridge the gap.

Target group/ Beneficiaries	Needs and Constraints	How the action will improve their situation
Youth (young women and men)	**Needs:** Market-relevant digital and soft skills; access to decent employment and entrepreneurship pathways; mentorship, networks, and career guidance. **Constraints:** High unemployment and limited job openings; skills mismatch and lack of practical experience; socio-political and geographic barriers to access.	Provide tiered training through AI, Animation, and Coding Schools; facilitate mentorship, career guidance, and networking through bootcamps, hackathons, and Entrepreneurship Adda; connect youth to internships, fellowships, and job opportunities, improving employability and career outcomes.
Local governments	**Needs:** Capacity building in digital governance and service delivery; technical support to manage innovation hubs; local policy and operational frameworks for digital transformation. **Constraints:** Limited ICT infrastructure and digital access; inadequate financial and human resources; weak implementation of national digital strategies.	Embed Innovation Fellows in 14 municipalities to co-develop innovation hubs; provide tailored digital literacy sessions and training for municipal staff; co-create and institutionalize SOPs and local policy frameworks to strengthen municipal capacity for digital transformation.
Academic Institutions	**Needs:** Updated, industry-relevant curriculum; faculty and student training in emerging digital technologies; access to incubation hubs and ICT resources. **Constraints:** Outdated curricula and slow adaptation to change; limited financial and technical capacity;	Support curriculum integration of AI, coding, animation, and digital safety into schools and colleges; partner with institutions to host hackathons, bootcamps, and training; enhance access to Shikshya.org and cooperative innovation hubs to bridge technology and knowledge gaps.

[12] Nepali Yuwa in Climate Action and Green Growth is a four-year EU-supported project led by YI-Lab that aims to promote the involvement of young Nepali people in green growth, environmental protection, and combatting climate change. More about the project - https://theyouthcan.org/.

[13] The recently endorsed National Youth Policy-2082 has defined youth as the young people between the age 18 and 35 years.

	bureaucratic rigidity in decision-making.	
CSOs/CBOs/ cooperatives	**Needs:** Digital literacy and media skills for effective member engagement; training on digital tools and platforms; support for digital strategy and outreach. **Constraints:** Resistance to digital transition; limited exposure to modern technologies; institutional capacity gaps; inadequate ICT infrastructure and financial resources.	Deliver tailored digital literacy programs and training on digital engagement tools; integrate Shikshya.org[14] into Heifer's cooperative platform to build capacity; and knowledge-sharing forums to strengthen digital participation and outreach.
Startup/ Enterprises	**Needs:** Access to finance, markets, and investors; business development support and mentorship; technical and digital capacity for growth. **Constraints:** Weak startup ecosystem and regulatory uncertainty; limited access to early-stage capital; market entry barriers and fragmented support systems.	Organize provincial and national bootcamps to strengthen business models; provide incubation, mentorship, and seed funding to selected enterprises; create linkages with investors, cooperatives, and private sector networks to accelerate growth and sustainability.

Key Stakeholder groups and their attitudes: The key stakeholder groups for this action include young people, youth organizations, local governments, the private sector, and academic institutions. YI-Lab's April 2025 assessment highlights that youth are looking for employment and entrepreneurship opportunities but continue to face significant barriers such as limited job openings, weak professional networks, and insufficient digital skills. Their strong demand for digital professionalism training demonstrates a high level of readiness to engage with structured programs like *Pathshala*'s tiered AI, Animation, and Coding Schools, as well as *Karmashala*'s internships and fellowships. Local governments have shown willingness to foster innovation hubs and integrate digital literacy into municipal plans, though they require capacity-building and skilled personnel to deliver inclusive services—gaps that *Nitishala's* fellowship model and policy dialogues are designed to address. The private sector is increasingly invested in youth-led innovation and workforce development in areas such as AI, e-commerce, and geospatial services, and supports initiatives like *Karyashala*'s hackathons and bootcamps as effective pathways to access skilled talent, while continuing to emphasize the need for improved soft skills and practical experience. Academic institutions are progressively aligning curricula with market demands and are open to co-developing content and hosting innovation activities to accelerate adoption. Collectively, these stakeholders form a mutually reinforcing ecosystem that, when supported through targeted training, financing, and collaboration, can drive inclusive employment creation, entrepreneurship, and systemic digital transformation across Nepal.

Throughout the project cycle, target groups will be engaged through inclusive forums, digital surveys, and feedback mechanisms to shape activities, monitor progress, and adjust approaches continuously. Innovation hubs will serve not only as service delivery points but also as participatory platforms where young people can lead initiatives, share knowledge, and drive peer-to-peer learning. These processes will promote local ownership, foster local leadership, and ensure that the action remains responsive, inclusive, and impactful.

Technical and management capacities of target groups and co-applicants: The target groups come with certain technical and management capacities. Youth women and men possess growing digital literacy, active peer networks, and strong familiarity with online platforms, enabling them to quickly adopt digital training programs and engage in virtual collaboration bring their skills and knowledge, and willingness to make an impact in their communities. Municipal governments have established governance and planning systems and operational authority to implement local programs, making them well-positioned to host and manage innovation hubs and support participatory decision-making. Academic institutions provide physical infrastructure such as computer labs, training halls, and libraries, as well as qualified faculty with technical expertise capable of delivering digital skills education and facilitating research and innovation events. CSOs and cooperatives offer strong community mobilization capacity, organizational structures, and local trust networks that are effective for outreach and disseminating learning resources. Startups and early-stage

[14] https://shikshya.org/ is an e-learning portal developed by YI-Lab that provides high-quality educational resources to students, educators, and lifelong learners. The portal includes low-bandwidth video streaming, interactive courses and quizzes, and a discussion forum.

enterprises demonstrate technical ingenuity and entrepreneurial initiative with digital solutions in agriculture, fintech, and e-commerce.

Together with lead and co-applicants of the action, they have the management and technical expertise to address these gaps and deliver results at scale. YI-Lab brings a proven track record of implementing multi-partner civic-tech initiatives and has extensive experience working with government institutions and youth groups to create experiential spaces for innovation and experimentation. NAAMII contributes cutting-edge expertise in AI education and competency-based matching of youth with jobs, internships, and fellowships. HPN anchors community-level implementation, leveraging three decades of grassroots engagement with municipalities and cooperatives to institutionalize innovation hubs and local policy dialogues. WIA provides technical training and mentorship in animation and creative technologies, fostering greater participation of women in the digital economy. Collectively, the co-applicants combine robust program management, technical leadership, and grassroots reach to ensure that UDAAN is implemented effectively, inclusively, and at scale.

(b) Intervention logic

From activities to outputs: The proposed action follows a structured results chain, beginning with targeted activities that generate six key outputs, all aimed at enhancing youth inclusion in Nepal's digital economy. Implemented over 48 months, the action starts with a six-month preparatory phase focused on internal capacity building, consortium coordination, personnel onboarding, and groundwork. This is followed by three 12-month implementation cycles covering four action components, allowing for iterative learning and adaptation. The final six months are dedicated to project closure, including evaluations, documentation, and stakeholder handover to ensure sustainability and continuity.

Output 1.1: Digital skills and knowledge strengthened among young women and men, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs

IF the AI School, Animation School, and Coding School are launched, **AND** the assumption holds that youth, women, and marginalized groups remain motivated to participate in digital skills programs and have reliable access to affordable devices and internet connectivity, **THEN** digital skills and knowledge will be strengthened among diverse groups. This output aims to equip young people, entrepreneurs, government officials, and civil society actors with the competencies needed to engage meaningfully in Nepal's rapidly advancing digital landscape.

The activities under Output 1.1 are designed to build competencies across three tiers—beginner (native[15]), intermediate (foundation[16]), and professional (deep skills[17]). Beginner-level courses target high school students, early-career professionals, government officials (Activity 2.3.2b), and CSO/CBO representatives to ensure digital literacy. Intermediate-level courses are tailored for youth and professionals seeking to enter the digital workforce. Professional-level courses prepare participants for employment and innovation in national and international digital markets.

Special emphasis is placed on women's participation, particularly in animation courses, where intermediate and professional tracks are designed to encourage women's representation in creative technologies. These activities were selected based on prior assessments and consultations with youth networks, educators, and local governments, which identified a critical need for structured, accessible, and market-relevant digital training programs.

Progress toward this output will be measured through three key indicators: (1) the number of young women and men completing foundational and deep AI courses; (2) the number of women completing intermediate and professional animation courses; and (3) the number of young women and men completing intermediate and professional coding courses. These indicators will be disaggregated by sex, age, disability status, rural/urban location, and ethnic group, where relevant, to ensure inclusive monitoring. Data will be collected by NAAMII, WIA-Nepal, and YI-Lab, as well as completion records and analytics from the Tangible Careers[18] and Shikshya.org platforms. Competency-based rubrics, project portfolios, and certification records will be used to verify achievement against targets.

[15] AI Native: Learners will be able to build an AI-first mindset and implement AI in their daily workflows.
[16] AI Foundational: Learners will be able to build AI systems that have different industry use cases.
[17] AI Deep: Learners will be able to do deep AI research work in different domains.
[18] Tangible Career (https://naamii.tangible.careers/) is a platform designed to bridge the gap between learning and hiring by mapping competencies and evaluating skills against industry standards. The platform's competency-based model dissects skills into detailed rubrics evaluated by mentors. The platform is being built for everyone who wants to learn AI, teach AI, get a job in AI, and hire AI talent. Tangible is also a deep-tech startup incubated at NAAMII.

Activity 1.1.1: AI School Offering Tiered Hybrid Courses

Under the *Pathshala* component of the action and led by NAAMII, the AI School delivers a three-tier program via the Tangible Careers platform, which is mobile-first and offline-capable to ensure equitable access. The Native level will reach 20,000 youth with eight hours of AI literacy and ethics, fostering broad digital awareness and disseminated via Shikshya.org. The Foundation level will train 1500 learners with 60 hours in intermediate AI/ML and data science through project-based learning using Nepal-specific datasets, preparing them for roles in fintech, agri-tech, and health-tech sectors. The Deep level will support 500 advanced learners with specialized training in deep learning, NLP (Natural Language Processing), and computer vision, embedding them in research-driven projects and providing access to GPU (Graphics Processing Unit) clusters and mentor guidance.

Activity 1.1.2: Animation School

Under the *Pathshala* component and implemented by WIA-Nepal, the Animation School aims to expand opportunities for women and the LGBTQI+ community aged 18–30 in the creative and digital sectors. The activity is structured into three progressive tiers. The Beginner tier introduces participants to digital creativity through short courses delivered via Shikshya.org, combining theoretical learning with hands-on assignments, and targets 5,000 participants to build foundational skills. The Intermediate tier offers project-based training in specialized tracks, including 3D Animation with AI Integration (a one-year Generalist Program), targeting 100 women, including LGBTQI+ participants, and includes mentorship and career counseling to support professional growth. The Professional tier focuses on Python programming with AI and Machine Learning over six months, engaging 100 women, including LGBTQI+ participants, and enabling them to work on industry-aligned projects and develop professional portfolios, preparing them for careers in animation, technology, or entrepreneurship.

Activity 1.1.3: Coding School Providing Multi-Level Programming Skills

Under the *Pathshala* component of the action and led by YI-Lab, Coding School delivers a structured, tiered curriculum designed to guide learners from basic digital literacy to advanced programming and problem-solving capabilities. At the Beginner level, the program targets 20,000 learners through Shikshya.org, where students learn to build static and interactive websites using HTML (HyperText Markup Language), CSS (Cascading Style Sheets), and JavaScript in project-based labs. The Intermediate level, reaching 4730 learners, focuses on modern web development tools such as React, Next.js, and PostgreSQL, enabling participants to create dynamic full-stack applications with authentication and deployment features. The Advanced level, designed for 270 learners, simulates professional developer workflows using Django and Django REST Framework (DRF), continuous integration and deployment (CI/CD) practices, and capstone projects. Learners can further specialize in tracks such as Full-Stack Development, AI Application Development, and GIS/Geo-Development, aligning their training with specific career goals and ensuring practical readiness for the digital workforce.

Output 1.2: Access to digital tools, platforms, and resources improved for youth, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs

IF online courses on Shikshya.org are launched, a mobile application is developed and also integrated in Heifer's cooperative digital platform is created, **AND** the assumption holds that internet connectivity and digital infrastructure scale up across provinces, including rural areas, **THEN** access to digital tools, platforms, and resources will be significantly improved for youth, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs specifically cooperatives. This output prioritizes expanding the reach, usability, and inclusivity of digital platforms to ensure that learning, skills development, and employment opportunities are accessible to all, regardless of geography or background.

The activities under Output 1.2 are designed to address the digital divide by enhancing Shikshya.org's content and accessibility. These interventions respond to the needs identified through stakeholder consultations and platform usage data, which highlighted the demand for localized, mobile-friendly, and low-bandwidth digital learning tools. The design and implementation of these platforms will be guided by principles of universal access, gender equity, and user-centered design, ensuring that marginalized and remote communities are not left behind in Nepal's digital transition.

Progress toward this output will be measured through two key indicators: (1) the number of learners enrolled in online courses on Shikshya.org and (2) the number of cooperatives benefitting from EU support. Indicators will be disaggregated by sex and age, and where possible, by disability status, rural/urban location, and identity group. Data will be collected through Shikshya.org analytics and course completion records.

Activity 1.2.1: Online Courses on Shikshya.org

Under the *Pathshala* component of the action and led by YI-Lab, this activity focuses on launching beginner and intermediate-level open-access courses on Shikshya.org. The platform will host modular, self-paced

courses on topics such as AI, coding, animation, cybersecurity, digital rights, and entrepreneurship. Each course will be designed to strengthen digital skills and job readiness, with content delivered in low-bandwidth formats and subtitles in both Nepali and English. Interactive features such as quizzes, discussion forums, and certification options will enhance learner engagement and support employability outcomes. The target is to enroll 45,000 young women and men on the platform, with at least 25% completing certifications.

Activity 1.2.2: Development of the Shikshya.org Mobile Application

Under the *Pathshala* component of the action and led by YI-Lab, to further improve accessibility, Shikshya.org will be developed into a mobile application, capitalizing on Nepal's high smartphone penetration. The app will offer a user-friendly interface optimized for low-connectivity environments, enabling learners to access content, track progress, and complete certifications directly from their devices. This mobile-first approach ensures that learners in rural areas can benefit from digital learning without relying on high-speed internet or desktop access.

Activity 1.2.3: Integration of Shikshya.org into Heifer's Cooperative Platform

Under the *Pathshala* component of the action, Shikshya.org will be integrated into Heifer's GeoKrishi SEWA platform, which already serves 300+ women's cooperatives and over 300,000 members. This integration will expand access to digital courses and strengthen female-led cooperatives by equipping them with knowledge in agri-tech, business digitization, and online markets. The platform will amplify outreach by embedding learning within the daily operations of cooperatives nationwide.

Output 2.1: Mechanisms for entrepreneurship development and mentorship support established for young people and CBOs

IF provincial and national bootcamps, incubation programs, mentorship, and seed funding are delivered, **AND** the assumptions hold that entrepreneurship remains a government priority and that young women and men are motivated to start enterprises, **THEN** mechanisms for entrepreneurship development and mentorship support will be established for young people and community-based organizations (CBOs). This output endeavors to build an enabling ecosystem for social and tech-driven enterprises by offering technical training, mentorship, and financial support, while strengthening peer networks and support systems for early-stage entrepreneurs.

The activities under this output are designed to address the barriers faced by youth and CBOs in accessing entrepreneurship resources, including limited exposure to business development tools, a lack of mentorship, and fragmented support systems. Through a combination of bootcamps, incubation, and mentorship, the action will build capacity, confidence, and connectivity among aspiring entrepreneurs. These activities were informed by consultations with youth groups, the private sector, and CSOs, and are aligned with Nepal's new Startup Policy and Digital Nepal Framework. The activities also draw on the "Entrepreneurship Adda" model established in YI-Lab's previously EU-funded theyouthCAN.org project, convening weekly interactive learning meetups with experts and youth entrepreneurs.

Progress will be measured through three indicators: (1) the number of enterprises participating in bootcamps; (2) the number of Entrepreneurship Adda sessions organized; and (3) the number of enterprises supported or sustained through EU support (GERF 2.13). These indicators will be disaggregated by sex, age, disability status, rural/urban location, and identity group where relevant. Data will be collected through bootcamp reports, mentorship logs, and annual interim reports, providing robust evidence of progress and impact.

Activity 2.1.1: Entrepreneurial Bootcamps Supporting Youth-and Women-Led Enterprises

Under the *Karyashala* component of the action, YI-Lab will lead the design and delivery of bootcamps at both provincial and national levels to equip youth-led enterprises with business and digital competencies. The bootcamps will focus on sessions on business modeling, AI for business, digital marketing, access to finance, and investor readiness. Each provincial bootcamp will engage 20 enterprises, including women- and youth-led initiatives from marginalized communities, while national-level bootcamps will serve as advanced platforms for refining business models and accessing seed funding. In total, 21 provincial and 3 national bootcamps will be conducted over the project period, and 9 enterprises will be awarded a product development grant as part of financial support to third parties.

Activity 2.1.1a: Provincial Bootcamps

Provincial bootcamps will provide three-day training tailored to nascent, early, and growth-stage enterprises. Outreach will be carried out through academic institutions, local governments, and CSOs to ensure inclusive participation. Provincial bootcamps will be conducted virtually, with support from academic institutions and local networks to provide space and ICT facilities where needed. Fellows stationed at project municipalities (More in Activity 2.3.3) through the Innovation Fellowship will support in outreach and dissemination of the

model at their assigned municipality. Sessions will include training on the Business Model Canvas, digital marketing, financial management, and AI for business, supported by Entrepreneurship Adda events where participants learn from successful entrepreneurs. Each provincial bootcamp will conclude with a pitch session, with the top two enterprises from each province advancing to the national level.

Activity 2.1.1b: National Bootcamp

At the National Bootcamp in Kathmandu, selected enterprises (14 from seven provinces) will refine their business plans under the guidance of sectoral experts and participate in exposure visits to leading innovation hubs and enterprises. The program will culminate in a Pitch Day, where three winning enterprises will be awarded a product development grant to scale their ventures.

Activity 2.1.2: Incubation and Mentorship for Social and Tech-Driven Enterprises

The three winning enterprises will enter a three- to six-month incubation program, receiving tailored mentorship, seed funding, and access to networks with financial institutions and government schemes. Peer-to-peer learning will be emphasized, enabling enterprises to exchange experiences and solutions. Participation in promotional events and ecosystem linkages will further support the sustainability and scaling of these enterprises.

Output 2.2: Youth-led digital innovations co-created to address challenges in public and private sectors

IF provincial and national hackathons are organized around problem statements collected from stakeholders from public and private sector including tech companies, banks, and incubators, **AND** the assumptions hold that these sectors are willing to adopt youth-led digital solutions and that emerging tech policies (e.g., AI regulation, data protection laws) do not impose restrictive barriers, **THEN** youth-led digital innovations can be co-created to address challenges in the public and private sectors. This output focuses on engaging young women and men in developing innovative solutions to pressing social and economic issues, while also providing mentorship, incubation, and opportunities for piloting their ideas.

The activities under Output 2.2 are designed to nurture grassroots innovation and amplify youth voices in digital transformation. Hackathons serve as a dynamic platform for young people to co-create, test, and pitch solutions to real-world challenges sourced from government, civil society, and private sector actors. These activities were informed by prior experience with theyouthCAN.org project and consultations with youth, academic institutions, and industry partners.

Progress toward this output will be measured through two indicators: (1) the number of team participating in hackathons through EU support and (2) the number of innovations/ideas from hackathons receiving mentorship. Evidence will be captured through hackathon reports, participation records, mentorship documentation, and prototype tracking, ensuring robust and verifiable measurement of innovation outcomes.

Activity 2.2.1: Organization of Hackathons on Public and Private Sector Challenges

Under the *Karyashala* component of the action and led by YI-Lab, hackathons will serve as the core platform for mobilizing youth-driven innovation, with 21 provincial and 3 national events engaging teams of 3–6 participants aged 18–35. Gender balance and inclusion will be prioritized in team formation and outreach. Problem statements will be sourced from government agencies, NGOs, and private sector partners to ensure relevance to real challenges. These events aim to foster creativity, collaboration, and solution-oriented thinking among youth, while also strengthening linkages between innovators and institutions. Nine promising ideas emerging from the hackathons will receive mentorship, industry placement, and an innovation grant for further development as part of financial support to third parties.

Activity 2.2.1a: Provincial Hackathons

Provincial hackathons will be organized in partnership with academic institutions, local governments, and CSOs to strengthen grassroots innovation ecosystems. A four-month call for applications will be launched with wide outreach through consortium networks. Before the hackathons, an online mentoring program will orient applicants to problem statements and project design. Teams will compete across diverse categories such as mobile applications, games, media products, toolkits, and campaigns. Proposals will be evaluated by a jury based on clarity, innovation, feasibility, sustainability, and inclusion. The top two teams from each province will be selected to advance to the national level. Facilities and logistical support will be provided where needed, including through fellows at the local level.

Activity 2.2.1b: National Hackathon

The national hackathon in Kathmandu, which will be organized in parallel with national bootcamps, will bring together the 14 provincial winners for a three-day event. Leading up to the competition, a 16-day mentorship program will help teams in refining their prototypes and strengthening technical and business aspects.

During the event, participants will receive targeted coaching from sector experts and pitch their innovations before government officials, private sector leaders, and EU/development sector representatives. The top three teams will be awarded seed funding and long-term mentorship opportunities, linking them to private sector partners and potential investors for piloting and scaling.

Output 2.3: Opportunities for professional experience created for young women and men

IF internship placements and fellowships in the private sector and municipalities are implemented, **AND** the assumption that government and private sector institutions remain willing and capable of providing a conducive environment for youth employment and professional experience holds true, **THEN** opportunities for practical experience can be created for young women and men across federal, provincial, and local levels. This output prioritizes equipping youth with hands-on exposure to evolving market dynamics, enabling them to build skills, networks, and portfolios that enhance employability in Nepal's digital economy.

Progress will be measured through four indicators: (1) the number of young women and men completing internships and fellowship supported by the intervention; (2) number of people who have benefited from institution or workplace based VET/skills development interventions supported by the EU (EURF 2.14) - number of young women and men embedded in municipal governments; (3) number of fellows and municipal representatives completing residential training; and (4) the number of municipal representatives and officials attending digital literacy sessions. Indicators will be disaggregated by sex, age, disability, rural/urban location, and identity group wherever possible. Verification will be documented through internship completion certificates, fellowship certificates, appointment letters and training reports.

Activity 2.3.1: Internships and Fellowships in the Private Sector

Under the *Karmashala* component of the action, 800 young women and men will be placed in structured professional placements in the private sector through the Tangible Career Platform. This will include 400 internships (up to 3 months), and 500 private sector fellowships (up to 5 months) delivered in hybrid formats. Placements will span diverse sectors, including financial institutions integrating AI, manufacturing firms implementing automation, agricultural cooperatives using AI for crop analysis, government agencies developing digital services, and international organizations with AI initiatives.

Placement matching will be carried out using NAAMII's Tangible Careers platform, which evaluates participants based on verified competencies rather than academic credentials. This ensures employers are paired with candidates who demonstrate practical skills in AI, automation, and digital innovation. Each participant will work on real-world projects, receive mentorship from industry practitioners, and be evaluated through performance-based systems. With a minimum of 40% women's participation and priority given to marginalized groups, the program will emphasize pathways to long-term employment. YI-Lab will leverage its employer partnerships, HPN will engage cooperative networks, and NAAMII will provide technical matching to create a seamless transition from digital learning to professional practice.

Activity 2.3.2: Municipal Innovation Fellowship for Establishing Local Innovation Hubs

Building on the successful Climate Fellowship model under the EU-supported theYouthCAN.org project, under the *Karmashala* component of the action, 14 young professionals will be embedded in municipal governments as Innovation Fellows for eight months and will be supported through an innovation fellowship grant as financial support to third parties. With a minimum of 40% women's participation, the fellowship targets fresh graduates and early-career youth under 29, prioritizing local candidates from disadvantaged groups and climate-vulnerable areas. Recruitment will be in partnership with academic institutions, local governments, and youth networks to ensure inclusive participation.

During their tenure, fellows will co-develop local incubation hubs, strengthen digital capacities of local governments, and support the integration of innovation into local policy processes. Each fellow will establish at least one community-driven digital solution addressing a local challenge while fostering grassroots entrepreneurship. Fellows will also facilitate youth outreach for provincial bootcamps and hackathons, ensuring strong alignment between innovation, capacity-building, and local development.

HPN will lead the implementation of the Innovation Fellowship, overseeing recruitment, placement, and mentorship. Detailed Terms of Reference will be prepared for each fellow, and the fellowship will be delivered in three cohorts (five fellows each in the first and second cohorts, and four in the third). Fellows will be supported throughout their placements with continuous mentorship, networking opportunities, and exposure to innovation ecosystems, ensuring that local governments are empowered to sustain the hubs and digital practices beyond the project.

Activity 2.3.2a: Five-day residential training to fellows and municipal representatives

Two weeks after placement, each Innovation Fellowship cohort will participate in a five-day residential training organized by HPN. This training, delivered jointly for fellows and local representatives, will cover AI,

digital rights, cybersecurity, and innovation hub management. It is designed to build shared knowledge, foster collaboration, and strengthen local ownership of digital transformation efforts. Training toolkits and modules will support practical application and ensure sustained capacity.

Activity 2.3.2b: Digital literacy sessions led by Innovation Fellows in Partnered Municipalities

Innovation Fellows will deliver tailored digital literacy sessions for local representatives, youth, women, cooperatives, and marginalized groups. Each fellow will target approximately 50 officials and 300 youth per local government. The sessions will build practical IT skills, introduce e-governance tools, and promote civic use of digital platforms, while also disseminating Shikshya.org courses. Training will be delivered in simple Nepali, using adult learning methods to ensure accessibility and local relevance.

Output 3.1: Engagement in digital dialogues, knowledge generation, and advocacy strengthened among youth to influence communities, especially women, marginalized groups, and disadvantaged CBOs

IF policy dialogues, dissemination of AI, animation, and coding curriculum, podcasts, and annual innovation carnivals are implemented, **AND** the assumptions that political and civic space remains open, institutional partners remain supportive, and young women, marginalized groups, and disadvantaged CBOs are motivated to participate hold true, **THEN** engagement in digital dialogues, knowledge generation, and advocacy can be strengthened among youth to influence communities. This output focuses on equipping fellows, municipal officials, schools, and cooperatives with the tools to advance digital transformation, while creating inclusive platforms for dialogue, innovation, and advocacy.

Progress will be measured through indicators (1) the number of policy dialogue events organized by fellows; (2) the number of SOPs for municipal innovation hubs developed; (3) the number of podcast episodes produced and disseminated; and (4) the number of Creator's Carnivals organized. Verification will be documented through event reports, attendance sheets, SOP drafts, and annual interim reports.

Activity 3.1.1: Policy Dialogues on Digital Transformation and Youth Issues in Partnered Municipalities

Under the *Nitishala* component, in collaboration with local authorities, HPN, through Innovation Fellows, will facilitate 28 policy dialogues (two per local government). These inclusive forums will convene youth, officials, and community stakeholders to discuss local priorities on digital transformation and youth engagement. Fellows will share field insights, sparking discussions on digital safety, entrepreneurship, and technology adoption. Outcomes will be documented and integrated into local planning processes to institutionalize an annual "Youth in Digital" forum.

Activity 3.1.2: Dissemination of AI, Coding, Animation, and Agri-Tech courses to the school

Under the *Nithishala* component, courses on AI, coding, animation, and digital safety hosted on Shikshya.org will be shared with academic institutions of the partnered municipalities to integrate into the school curriculum. HPN will collaborate with academic institutions and local governments to ensure smooth adoption, while YI-Lab will provide technical support. This activity promotes early exposure to digital tools among students, building a pipeline of digitally literate youth.

Activity 3.1.3: Innovation hubs establishment

Under the *Nithishala* component, HPN will collaborate with all 14 municipalities to co-develop Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) that guide the establishment, management, and sustainability of municipal innovation hubs. These SOPs, developed through a participatory process facilitated by municipal fellows, will define governance structures, resource requirements, personnel roles and responsibilities, business outreach strategies, market linkages, and youth engagement processes. By tailoring each SOP to the local context, the hubs will be positioned as practical, policy-backed platforms that municipalities can operate and sustain independently beyond the project period.

To strengthen the establishment of the hubs, physical assets such as computers, smart TVs, projectors, and other equipment will be provided based on the needs identified through the assessments. To ensure local ownership and long-term commitment, municipalities will be required to co-finance a portion of the hub setup costs, thereby embedding financial and institutional accountability into the process.

Activity 3.1.6: "Innovation Unplugged" Podcast

Under the *Nitishala* component, YI-Lab will produce "Innovation Unplugged", a 50-episode podcast series featuring diverse voices on digital inclusion, cybersecurity, and emerging technologies. Disseminated through consortium channels, YouTube, and collaborations with featured guests, the podcast will amplify underrepresented perspectives and create a platform for advocacy and thought leadership on Nepal's digital future.

Activity 3.1.8: Creator's Carnival

Under the *Nitishala* component, YI-Lab will organize an annual Creator's Carnival in partnership with the private sector and tech actors. This national event will convene creators, developers, academia, policymakers, and CSOs to network, showcase innovations, and advocate for digital rights and inclusion. Over the project period, three Carnivals will be hosted, creating a recurring space for collaboration, policy dialogue, and celebration of Nepal's digital ecosystem.

From outputs to outcomes: The proposed action is designed to deliver six interlinked outputs that collectively contribute to three strategic outcomes, each aimed at advancing youth inclusion in Nepal's digital economy. These outputs span digital skills development, access to tools, entrepreneurship support, innovation, professional experience, and civic engagement. Together, they form a coherent results framework that strengthens individual competencies, institutional capacities, and systemic enablers. By aligning outputs with inclusive indicators and targeted interventions, the action ensures that young women and men, especially from marginalized communities, are equipped not only to participate in the digital landscape but to influence and shape it. The outcomes reflect this transformation: enhanced competitiveness, increased contribution to digital solutions, and equitable participation in digital dialogues and governance.

Outcome 1: Enhanced competitiveness of young Nepali women and men to succeed in a digital world and job market

Outcome 1 will be achieved **IF** Output 1.1 (digital skills and knowledge strengthened) and Output 1.2 (access to digital tools, platforms, and resources improved) are realized, **AND** the assumption holds that digital infrastructure continues to expand and youth remain motivated to upgrade their skills. **THEN**, young women and men will be more competitive in Nepal's digital job market. This is **BECAUSE** experience from NAAMII's annual AI School, which delivers advanced AI training, shows that participants have successfully secured placements in AI companies in Nepal and abroad, and many have pursued PhD and Master's-level programs for deeper AI specialization. Furthermore, participants who have applied these competencies in their workplaces have been able to compete for promotions and salary increments. Building on this evidence, the action's tiered training model and inclusive digital platforms are designed to ensure that youth from diverse backgrounds, including those from marginalized and remote communities, can develop employability skills and successfully transition into meaningful employment or entrepreneurship.

Progress toward Outcome 1 will be measured through three indicators: (i) the proportion of young women and men completing Shikshya.org courses and certification with a target of 25%, (ii) the proportion of learners demonstrating improved digital competency scores through standardized testing with a target of 80%, and (iii) the number of trained youths securing employment, internships, or self-employment in digital sectors within six months of training with a target of 40%. Data will be collected through platform analytics, institutional reports, and follow-up surveys, with disaggregation by sex, age, disability, rural/urban location, and identity groups, where relevant, to ensure inclusive monitoring.

Outcome 2: Enhanced contribution of young Nepali women and men in developing and implementing digital solutions to address challenges faced by the public and private sectors

Outcome 2 will be achieved **IF** Output 2.1 (entrepreneurship and mentorship mechanisms), Output 2.2 (youth-led digital innovations), and Output 2.3 (professional experience opportunities) are realized, **AND** the assumptions hold that mentors, investors, and local governments remain engaged and that sufficient financial and technical resources are available to support youth-led initiatives. **THEN,** young people will be able to contribute meaningfully to the development and implementation of digital solutions addressing public and private sector challenges. This is **BECAUSE** evidence from the EU-funded theYouthCAN.org project demonstrates that when youth are provided with mentorship, resources, and market exposure, they can translate ideas into viable enterprises: 17 aspiring entrepreneurs registered their businesses and successfully introduced products to market during the project. This experience shows that creating a conducive environment with sustained mentorship, bootcamps, hackathons, and incubation support enables young innovators to invest their time and resources in developing solutions that generate employment, foster innovation, and contribute to local economic growth.

Progress toward Outcome 2 will be measured through two indicators: (i) the number of youth-led digital solutions such as prototypes, apps, platforms, or services developed through hackathons, with a target of 9 ideas, and (ii) the number of social and tech enterprises established by youth and supported by the intervention, with the target of 9 enterprises. Data will be collected through hackathon reports, company registration records, and annual interim reports, with disaggregation by sex, age, disability, rural/urban location, and identity groups, where relevant, to ensure inclusive monitoring.

Outcome 3: Increased and equitable digital participation of young Nepali women and men, specifically from marginalized and minority communities and remote areas

Outcome 3 will be achieved **IF** Output 3.1 (engagement in digital dialogues, knowledge generation, and advocacy) is realized, **AND** the assumptions hold that governments remain open to youth engagement, and that schools, cooperatives, and local governments remain committed to digital transformation. **THEN**, digital participation among young Nepali women and men, particularly from marginalized communities and remote areas, will increase and become more equitable. This is **BECAUSE** past experience from the Climate Fellowship component of the EU-funded theYouthCAN.org project demonstrated that embedding youth fellows at the municipal level not only strengthened technical capacity within local governments but also directly supported the development and endorsement of 27 municipal plans and policies, including SOPs for the operation of the Bipad Portal

[19] and Local Disaster and Climate Resilience Plans. Building on this proven model, the action will deliver municipal-level trainings, curriculum integration support, cooperative outreach, and national advocacy events to ensure that young women and men, including those from remote and marginalized communities, are not merely participants but leaders shaping digital governance efforts.

Progress toward Outcome 3 will be measured through four indicators: (i) the number of government policies developed or revised with CSO participation through EU support (GERF 2.29), with a target of 14, (ii) the proportion of supported youth actively engaging with local governments on digital literacy and innovation hub promotion, with a target of 80%, (iii) the number of innovation hubs operationalized by local governments through EU support, with a target of 14, and (iv) the number of schools integrating AI, coding, animation, and agri-tech courses into their curricula, with a target of 14. Data will be collected through endorsement letters, curriculum integration reports, and municipal updates, with disaggregation by sex, age, disability, rural/urban location, and identity groups, where relevant, to ensure inclusive monitoring.

From outcomes to impact: The proposed action is expected to contribute to the overarching impact of increased inclusion of young Nepali women and men in the digital world and job market, realized through digital literacy, upskilling, innovation, and market readiness. This impact will be realized **IF** the three outcomes—Outcome 1 (enhanced competitiveness), Outcome 2 (enhanced contribution to digital solutions), and Outcome 3 (increased and equitable digital participation)—are achieved, **AND** the assumptions at the outcome level hold true. These assumptions include a stable socio-political environment, continued policy support for youth engagement and innovation, and sustained public-private commitment to co-create opportunities for young people.

THEN, the action will generate the desired impact. This is **BECAUSE** the combination of targeted digital skills development, entrepreneurship support, civic engagement, and inclusive access to platforms will empower youth, particularly women and marginalized groups, to actively participate in Nepal's digital transformation and secure meaningful employment. Evidence from previous EU-supported initiatives and national programs confirms that when youth are equipped with relevant skills and opportunities, they can drive innovation, influence policy, and improve economic and social outcomes.

Progress toward this impact will be measured using indicators that align with Nepal's national SDG framework while also serving as a reference for the project's contribution through three key indicators (i) the proportion of youth aged 15–24 not in education, employment, or training (SDG 8.6.1), with a target to reduce this figure to 15% by 2030; (ii) the Social Empowerment Index (SDG 10.2.1(1)), which is expected to increase to 0.7 by 2030, reflecting improvements in youth agency, participation, and inclusion and (iii) the Economic Empowerment Index (SDG 10.2.1(2)), with a target increase to 0.7 by 2030, indicating enhanced access to income-generating opportunities and financial independence among youth. Data for these indicators will be drawn from the National Planning Commission's SDG review datasets.

[19] Bipad Portal is national integrated disaster information management system under the ownership of National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority

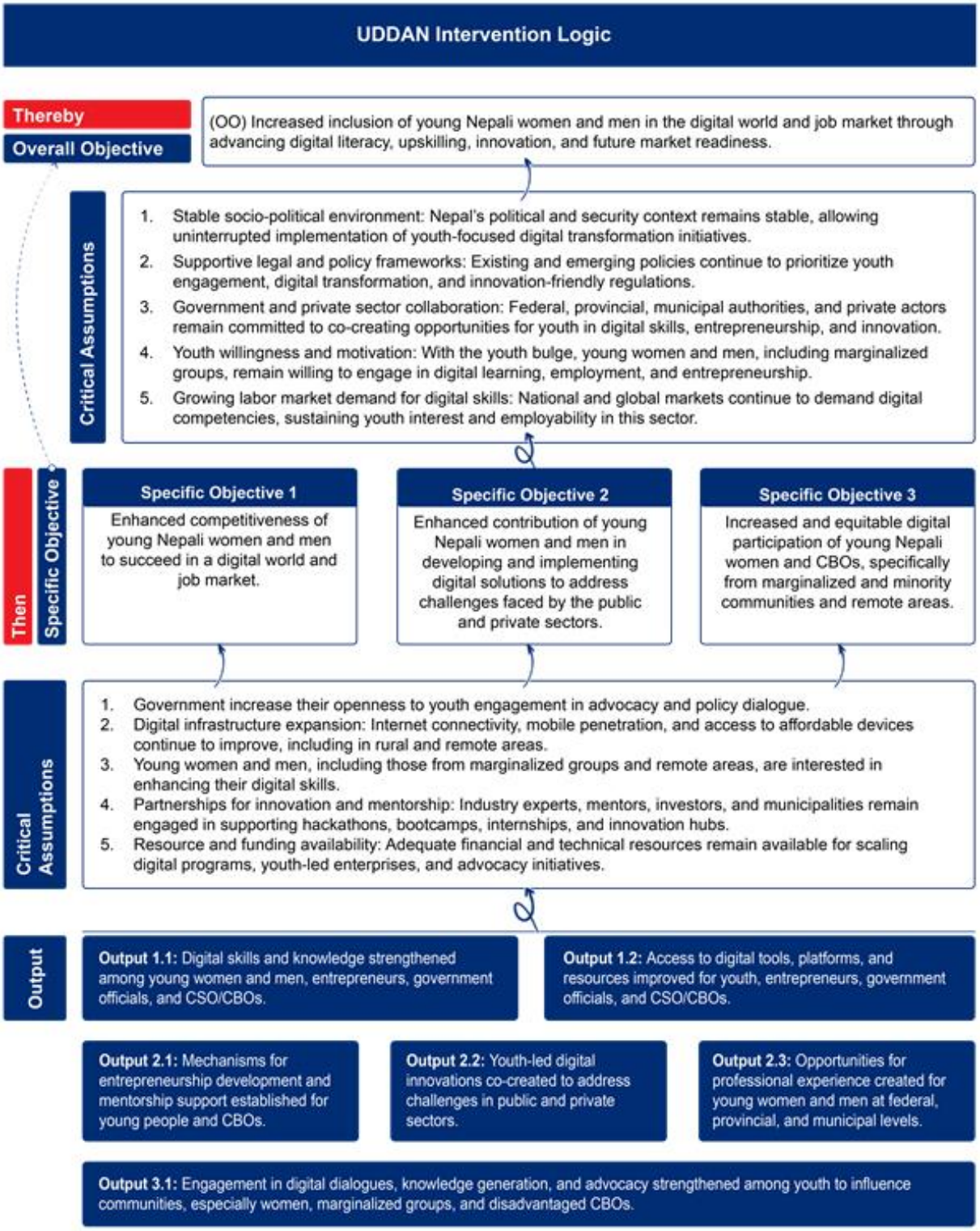


Figure 1: Intervention logic of the UDDAN project

(c) **Financial support to third parties**: The action will provide financial support to third parties to enable and empower youth to participate actively in governance processes and develop innovative solutions to address pressing environmental and socio-economic challenges in their communities. This support will be delivered through three key instruments: Innovation Fellowship Grants, Product Development Grants for social and tech enterprises, and Innovation Grants for hackathon winners. Following a competitive process of application review and interviews, the selection committee will award 14 Innovation Fellowship Grants to young professionals embedded in municipal governments, 9 Product Development Grants to early-stage enterprises, and 9 Innovation Grants to promising hackathon teams.

Grant amounts will vary based on the nature of activities and level of effort required, with a maximum of EUR 3795.00 per award. Fellowship grants will cover fellows' remuneration, travel, communication costs, and expenses for community outreach and policy dialogue in their assigned municipalities. Product Development and Innovation Grants will support enterprise registration, procurement of raw materials, prototype development, and associated travel and accommodation costs. Disbursement will be milestone-based or provided monthly, linked to deliverables to ensure accountability.

The total estimated allocation for third-party financing under this action is EUR 67,192.56, representing a direct investment in youth-led initiatives that advance the objectives of the project, strengthening governance, fostering entrepreneurship, and promoting innovation space.

2.1.2. Methodology (max 5 pages)

i. Implementation methods and rationale for such methodology

The proposed action is structured around four interrelated action components designed to build digital skills, foster innovation, enhance employability, and strengthen institutional capacity. It integrates a risk-informed approach to address structural barriers, reduce vulnerabilities, and ensure inclusive, adaptive, and sustainable outcomes across all seven provinces of Nepal.

1. *Pathshala* builds foundational digital competencies through multi-level courses in AI, coding, animation, cybersecurity, and digital rights, reaching youth, including women and those from marginalized communities.
2. *Karyashala* channels these skills into innovation and entrepreneurship through hackathons and bootcamps, supporting youth-led social and tech enterprises.
3. *Karmashala* connects youth to real-world opportunities through internships and fellowships and will link youth to jobs, training, and scholarships, reducing access gaps.
4. *Nitishala* ensures sustainability through institutional support and policy engagement, including training and digital literacy sessions for elected representatives and local government stakeholders, policy dialogues, SOP development for innovation hubs, a podcast series on digital inclusion, and promotes early digital literacy by integrating content into school curricula.

Each component of the action will follow three phases. The preparatory phase will focus on groundwork, including curriculum development for AI, animation, and coding schools, signing agreements with local governments, and youth outreach. The implementation phase will execute the designed activities, such as multi-level digital courses, hackathons, bootcamps, internships, and policy dialogues, ensuring outputs are achieved. The handover phase will prioritize sustainability, including documenting best practices, institutionalizing innovation hubs, and sharing lessons learned for replication and scale-up. The following approaches will be incorporated within the action.

Hybrid and Multi-Level Approach: The action will adopt a hybrid, multi-level implementation approach that combines digital platforms such as Shikshya.org and Tangible Careers, in-person training including bootcamps, hackathons, and municipal fellowships, and structured policy engagement. This blend ensures accessibility across Nepal's diverse geography, where digital penetration is uneven, but smartphone use and 4G coverage are steadily expanding. The hybrid model maximizes reach for youth in remote areas through low-bandwidth online delivery while providing hands-on, demand-driven experiences in physical learning environments.

Stakeholder Engagement and Co-Creation: The action will be implemented in close collaboration with local governments, CSOs, cooperatives, and private sector partners. Formal MoUs with selected local governments will create ownership of innovation hubs, while cooperatives will be engaged to integrate digital literacy into local enterprises. Private sector actors will provide mentorship, internships, and access to markets, ensuring employability and entrepreneurship opportunities are demand driven. Youth will be placed at the center of all activities, with open access in Shikshya.org to beginner and intermediate courses, competitive selection for advanced-level training and fellowships, and targeted outreach to youth, including those from women, marginalized communities, and living in remote areas. Community co-creation methods, such as participatory policy dialogues and curriculum working groups with educators, will ensure activities are inclusive, context-appropriate, and sustainable.

Capacity Development and Iterative Learning: Capacity building runs as a core element across all action components. Training will be delivered in hybrid formats, combining online courses with in-person mentoring and hands-on exercises. Fellows will follow a training-of-trainers approach to cascade digital literacy to wider audiences. Hackathon and bootcamp winners will receive mentorship and incubation support. Training content will be localized to the Nepali context as well as made province-specific where appropriate and delivered iteratively, with short, repeated sessions that allow participants to practice skills, receive feedback, and reinforce learning.

Core Inputs

Equipment & Software: High-performance computers, licensed software, projectors, and reliable internet connections will be deployed to simulate professional work environments and facilitate the delivery of industry-standard training courses. Dedicated computing systems and licensed software will allow the Animation School to equip participants with market-relevant technical skills, while coding and AI courses will require similar infrastructure to provide hands-on practice. High-speed internet and audiovisual systems will support blended and online classes, and training venues will be selected to ensure physical accessibility for participants.

Learning Materials: The project will develop and disseminate a comprehensive set of resources, including curricula, course modules, assignments, project briefs, SOP manuals, digital literacy toolkits, and policy briefs. These resources will cover AI, animation, and coding schools, fellowship and internship programmes, and local government innovation hubs. Structured, high-quality materials will promote consistency across provinces, provide replicable models for future programmes, and equip learners and institutions with resources that remain relevant beyond the project's duration.

Human Resources: A diverse team of trainers, mentors, fellowship supervisors, career coaches, and programme team members will be mobilised to deliver technical courses, provide mentorship, and guide youth throughout the implementation period. Trainers and mentors with expertise in AI, animation, coding, digital rights, and entrepreneurship will lead the learning components, while supervisors and career coaches will strengthen employability pathways. The program team will ensure efficient delivery, effective coordination among partners, and compliance with EU requirements.

Digital Platforms: The action will enhance Shikshya.org and Tangible Careers. Shikshya.org will be upgraded to a mobile application with low-bandwidth streaming, interactive modules, and gamified features to expand access for youth in remote areas. Tangible Careers will be improved with offline synchronisation, mobile optimisation, Nepal-specific datasets, and culturally adapted interfaces to ensure usability and context relevance.

Rationale of Overall Methodology: The overall methodology has been designed to address the systemic barriers young people in Nepal face in accessing digital opportunities by combining skills development, innovation, employability, and institutional anchoring into a coherent approach. The four interconnected components, *Pathshala, Karyashala, Karmashala,* and *Nitishala*, together create a pipeline that moves youth from foundational digital skills to practical innovation, professional experience, and policy engagement. By adopting a hybrid, multi-level approach, the action ensures that digital learning is accessible even in low-connectivity areas while maintaining high-quality, industry-standard training through in-person activities. Stakeholder engagement and co-creation with local governments, CSOs, cooperatives, and the private sector will help to ensure that interventions are locally owned, context-sensitive, and demand-driven, while youth are placed at the centre of all decision-making and delivery processes. Iterative training and mentorship models strengthen knowledge retention and ensure learning translates into employment and entrepreneurship. Collectively, this methodology ensures inclusive, risk-informed, and scalable solutions that reduce digital inequalities, enhance employability, and institutionalise digital innovation across Nepal.

ii. Continuation of previous action

While the proposed action is not a direct continuation of a previous project, it is designed on the basis of lessons learned, institutional expertise, and successful models tested in earlier initiatives. In particular, it leverages and expands existing platforms that have already demonstrated effectiveness in providing digital learning and experiential opportunities for young women and men. The Tangible Careers platform, developed by NAAMII, has pioneered a competency-based model that bridges the gap between learning and hiring by mapping skills against industry standards and enabling mentor-led evaluation. Under this action, the platform will be enhanced with offline synchronization and mobile optimization to address Nepal's connectivity challenges, making it more accessible to youth and directly linking them to internships and fellowship opportunities. Similarly, Shikshya.org, an e-learning portal developed by YI-Lab, has already reached thousands of learners with high-quality, low-bandwidth video streaming, interactive courses, and quizzes. Building on this success, the portal will be upgraded into a mobile application with expanded low bandwidth streaming and interactive modules, enabling even broader reach across remote and marginalized communities.

The design of the action also draws on the positive experiences and best practices of the EU-supported theYouthCAN.org project, particularly its Innovation Fellowship model and youth-focused bootcamps. Evaluations from that project highlighted the value of embedding young fellows in local governments to strengthen institutional capacities, the importance of mentorship in sustaining youth-led enterprises, and the need for strong municipal ownership to ensure long-term impact. These lessons are directly integrated into the design of UDAAN through the Innovation Fellowship, municipal innovation hubs, and structured mentorship pathways for bootcamp and hackathon winners. Furthermore, the establishment of AI School, Animation School, and Coding School builds on the institutional expertise of YI-Lab, NAAMII, and WIA-Nepal, ensuring high-quality and industry-relevant curricula. The long-standing experience of HPN in engaging with local governments and cooperatives further enriches the design by anchoring innovation and digital literacy within community structures.

iii. Potential synergies with other initiatives

The action complements Nepal's Digital Nepal Framework (2019), Startup Policy (2024), and Youth Vision 2025, while reinforcing the 16th Periodic Plan and the National Cybersecurity Policy (2023) by advancing

digital literacy, employability, and innovation. It builds on the EU-supported theYouthCAN.org project and aligns with EU initiatives, while also complementing UNESCO and EU-supported Media and Information Literacy programs. At a broader level, it will establish synergies with GIZ's GRAPE II program, World Bank digital innovation initiatives, and private sector incubators, ensuring efficient use of resources and maximizing reach. By connecting with these national, EU, and international efforts, the action will strengthen coordination, avoid duplication, and enhance long-term sustainability.

iv. Organization structure and team proposed

To ensure effective governance and delivery of the action, a two-tiered project management structure will be established:

Project Accountability Team (PAT): A high-level PAT, comprising the organizational heads of YI-Lab, NAAMII, HPN, and WIA-Nepal, will be established to provide strategic direction, oversight, and decision-making support for the action. Meeting on a biannual basis or more frequently if required, the PAT will review progress against the Logical Framework and key performance indicators, address implementation challenges and risks, approve major course corrections, and guide the overall sustainability of the project and stakeholder engagement efforts.

Project Implementation Team: For the day-to-day execution of the action, a Project Implementation Team will be constituted, comprising program team members from YI-Lab and all co-applicants. The PIT will meet monthly to review ongoing activities, share updates, and resolve operational challenges. It will coordinate efforts across the four components—*Pathshala, Karyashala, Karmashala,* and *Nitishala*—to ensure smooth and integrated implementation. The team will also proactively identify risks, develop and apply mitigation measures, and plan upcoming activities in line with the project's timelines and deliverables.

In total, over 40 team members (working full-time, part-time, and consulting) across consortium partners will support the design, implementation, monitoring, and reporting of the action, ensuring a well-coordinated and results-driven approach.

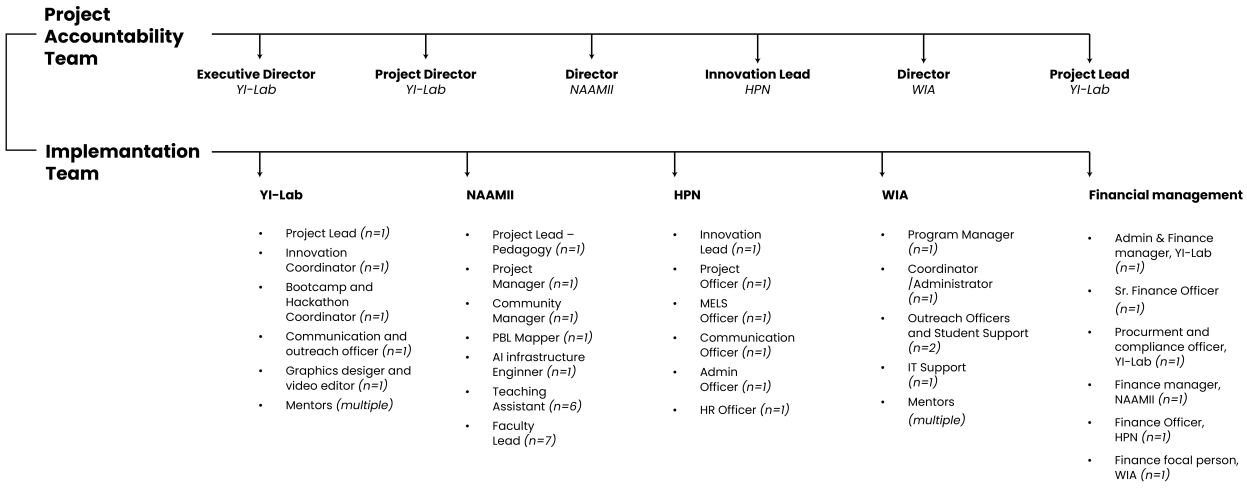


Figure 2: Project team members proposed for the action

v. Role and participation in the action of the various actors and stakeholders, and why these roles have been assigned

The action will be implemented by a consortium of four organizations, each contributing a balance of technical innovation, grassroots reach, policy influence, and gender-transformative practice. Together, they ensure that the action delivers results at scale while sustaining outcomes beyond the project period.

Youth Innovation Lab (YI-Lab). Established in 2017, YI-Lab is a non-profit civic tech organization and the lead applicant for this action. It has led multiple donor-funded projects, including the EU-funded Nepali Yuwa in Climate Action and Green Growth project, and has become a pioneer in creating spaces for youth and young professionals in Nepal. Its institutional expertise spans entrepreneurship, education, disaster risk reduction, climate, and information management systems, with youth engagement at the core. As lead applicant, YI-Lab will take overall responsibility for coordination, donor liaison, financial management, monitoring and evaluation, and compliance with EU requirements. It will also lead the design and delivery of activities under *Pathshala* (coding schools), *Karyashala* (hackathons and bootcamps), and elements of *Nitishala* (podcast and Creator's Carnival). YI-Lab's leadership role is rooted in its proven capacity to

manage complex, multi-stakeholder programs, deliver civic tech and youth-focused digital initiatives, and engage government actors at federal, provincial, and municipal levels.

Nepal Applied Mathematics and Informatics Institute for Research (NAAMII). Founded in 2018 by scientists and professionals with international research and medical experience, NAAMII is a leading non-profit institute advancing artificial intelligence, applied mathematics, and informatics in Nepal. With more than 30 staff and researchers, NAAMII is recognized as the country's center of excellence in AI research and education. In UDAAN, NAAMII, as a co-applicant, will co-lead *Pathshala* by delivering comprehensive AI education at three tiers (Native, Foundation, and Deep) and lead *Karmashala* by enhancing the Tangible Careers platform. NAAMII's role is vital because it anchors the action in global standards of AI research and pedagogy, while adapting content to Nepal's context and infrastructure, ensuring both technical rigor and employability relevance.

Heifer Project Nepal (HPN). Established in 1996, HPN is one of Nepal's most experienced NGOs, with nearly three decades of work in community development, women's empowerment, and cooperative strengthening. It has extensive experience working with more than 50 municipalities and over 300 cooperatives to promote agribusiness, entrepreneurship, and livelihoods, supported by its relationship agreement with Heifer International. In UDAAN, HPN, as a co-applicant, will lead the Innovation Fellowship under *Karmashala* and play a central role in *Nitishala* (Bridging Policy and Practice), including the establishment of innovation labs, policy dialogues, digital literacy programs for government officials, and curriculum integration. HPN's role is critical to ensuring that digital interventions reach communities and are institutionalized within municipal structures. By leveraging its grassroots networks, HPN will connect rural women, cooperatives, and local governments to digital literacy and innovation opportunities, anchoring sustainability at the community level.

Women in Animation Nepal (WIA-Nepal). Established in 2023, WIA-Nepal is the youngest member of the consortium and is dedicated to improving women's participation in the animation and visual effects industry through education, engagement, and employment of women. Despite its recent establishment, WIA brings a strong gender-transformative perspective and practical experience in delivering training, mentorship, and exposure opportunities to women entering creative technology fields. In UDAAN, WIA, as a co-applicant, will lead the Animation School of *Pathshala* and manage related training in Python and AI-linked creative applications. It will also provide career guidance and exposure programs to ensure that women participants are equipped with not only technical skills but also networks and pathways into professional opportunities.

Other Stakeholders. Beyond the consortium, municipal governments will host Innovation Fellows, co-develop innovation hubs, and participate in policy dialogues, ensuring institutionalization and ownership at the local level. Civil society organizations, cooperatives, and community-based organizations will support outreach and mobilization of marginalized youth, women, and indigenous groups, ensuring inclusivity. Academic institutions will partner in hosting hackathons, bootcamps, and curriculum integration processes, linking project activities with formal education systems. The private sector, including tech companies, banks, and incubators, will contribute mentorship, internships, and market linkages, ensuring that youth engagement is demand-driven and aligned with economic opportunities.

vi. Planned monitoring arrangements and subsequent follow-up.

A comprehensive monitoring and evaluation (M&E) framework will be developed during the first quarter of the action, setting out the indicators, tools, and responsibilities in alignment with the Logical Framework (Annex C) through the engagement of M&E expert. Monthly, quarterly, and annual reporting mechanisms will be put in place to document progress, achievements, challenges, lessons, and mitigation measures. Standardized templates, including a communication plan, narrative, and financial reporting formats, attendance sheets, brochures for the action and its components, a common policy framework, procurement plan, and detailed implementation plans for each component, will be developed to ensure consistency across the consortium.

Monitoring will take place at multiple levels. Activity and output-level monitoring will be carried out monthly and quarterly by YI-Lab in close coordination with consortium partners, using both narrative and financial reporting. Outcome-level monitoring will include digital data from Shikshya.org and the Tangible Careers platform, supplemented by beneficiary surveys and focus group discussions. At the end of each year, YI-Lab will organize a learning and experience-sharing event to review results, reflect on lessons, and adapt strategies. YI-Lab will also carry out regular financial monitoring and compliance checks to ensure that implementation by consortium partners is fully in line with EU policies. Additional financial and compliance monitoring will be undertaken by a professional with experience in EU funding. Furthermore, an annual external audit will be conducted by an independent auditor.

vii. The planned internal/external evaluation processes

Internal evaluations will be carried out by the project team at the end of each project year, focusing on results achieved, challenges faced, and opportunities for adaptation. Findings from these internal evaluations will be shared with consortium partners to inform subsequent planning and strengthen ownership.

In addition, external evaluations will be conducted to provide independent assessments of performance and impact. A mid-term evaluation may be commissioned to capture early outcomes and provide recommendations for course correction, while a final external evaluation will be carried out in the last quarter of the action period to assess overall effectiveness, impact, sustainability, and EU value added. These evaluations will be conducted by independent evaluators recruited through transparent procurement processes. The recommendations will be disseminated to consortium partners, relevant stakeholders, and the EU and integrated into follow-up actions, replication strategies, and policy dialogues.

viii. Visibility of the EU's financial contribution

A comprehensive Communication and Visibility Plan will be developed during the inception phase and implemented by all consortium members, with a dedicated communications and outreach officer and a graphic designer, ensuring quality delivery in close coordination with the EU Delegation. In line with EU Communication and Visibility Guidelines, all project materials, including curricula, training modules, reports, brochures, digital platforms, and certificates, will prominently acknowledge the EU's financial contribution in both English and Nepali. Municipal innovation labs will have EU-visibility branding, and all major events such as hackathons, bootcamps, the Creator's Carnival, policy dialogues, and fellowship programs will carry EU branding. Press releases will be issued at project launch, key milestones, and closeout to secure national and local media coverage, while social media campaigns and podcasts will consistently highlight EU support using coordinated hashtags and tagging the EU Delegation. Success stories, short videos, and a final publication capturing results and lessons will also be widely disseminated with EU branding, reinforcing the EU's visibility as a key partner in advancing digital skills and youth empowerment in Nepal.

2.1.3. Indicative action plan for implementing the action (max 4 pages)

The action plan will be drawn up using the following format:

Year 1													
	Half-year 1						Half-year 2						
Activity	M1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	Implementing body
1. Submission of project to Social Welfare Council for approval													YI-Lab
2. Partnership Agreement with Consortium Partners for project implementation													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
3. Staff Recruitment													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
4. Setting up governing structure for the project implementation													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
4.1 Setting up Project Accountability Team (PAT)													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
4.2 Setting up Project Implementation Team (PIT)													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
5. Orientation to the Project Team members covering both the program and finance aspect													YI-Lab
6. Baseline and scoping study													YI-Lab
7. System audit of YI-Lab and Consortium Partners to identify any gaps and set action plan to ensure financial and legal compliance													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
8. Meetings													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
8.1 PAT meeting													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
8.2 Monthly Project Implementation Team's meeting													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
8.3 Semi-annual/Annual review meeting													
9. Development of framework and templates													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9.1: Development of Communication Plan													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9.2: Monthly, Quarterly narrative and financial reporting template													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9.3: Attendance Sheet template													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9.4: Project Brochure and separate brochure for each project component													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9.5: Development of common policy for the project													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9.6: Development of procurement plan													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9.7. Development of comprehensive implementation plan of each component													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
10.2 Quarterly reporting (narrative and financial) from Consortium Partners													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
10.3 Annual Interim Report (narrative and financial) to the EU													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
11. Monitoring Visit													YI-Lab, HPN
12. Project Audit													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Output 1.1: Digital skills and knowledge strengthened among young women and men, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs.													

Preparatory work for Output 1.1 that includes Course design, curriculum development, and outreach.													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Activity 1.1.1: AI School Offering Tiered Hybrid Courses													NAAMII
Activity 1.1.2: Animation School													WIA
Activity 1.1.3: Coding School Providing Multi-Level Programming and Problem-Solving Skills													YI-Lab
Output 1.2: Access to digital tools, platforms, and resources improved for youth, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs.													
Preparatory work for Output 1.2 includes onboarding of experts/mentors for curriculum development.													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Activity 1.2.1: Online Courses on Shikshya.org													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Activity 1.2.2: Development of the Shikshya.org Mobile Application													YI-Lab
Activity 1.2.3: Integration of Shikshya.org in Heifer's cooperative digital platform													HPN
Output 2.1: Mechanisms for entrepreneurship development and mentorship support established for young people and CBOs.													
Preparatory work for Output 2.1 includes guidelines development for idea call, development of outreach plan, and partnership with relevant stakeholders													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Activity 2.1.1: Entrepreneurial Bootcamps Supporting Youth-and Women-Led Enterprises													YI-Lab, HPN
Activity 2.1.1a: Provincial Bootcamps.													YI-Lab
Activity 2.1.1b: National Bootcamp.													YI-Lab
Activity 2.1.2: Incubation and Mentorship for Social and Tech-Driven Enterprises													YI-Lab
Output 2.2: Youth-led digital innovations co-created to address challenges in public and private sectors.													
Preparatory work for Output 2.2 includes guidelines development for idea submission, development of outreach plan, and partnership with relevant stakeholders													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Activity 2.2.1: Organization of Hackathons on Public and Private Sector Challenges													YI-Lab, NAAMII
Activity 2.2.1a: Provincial Hackathons.													YI-Lab
Activity 2.2.1b: National Hackathons.													YI-Lab
Output 2.3: Opportunities for professional experience created for young women and men at federal, provincial, and municipal levels.													
Preparatory work for Output 2.3 includes outreach and selection of young women and men for internship and fellowships. For Innovation Fellowship, the preparatory work also includes identification of project municipality and partnership with them.													YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Activity 2.3.1: Internship and fellowship in the private sector													NAAMII
Activity 2.3.3: Municipal Innovation Fellowship for Establishing Local Innovation Hubs													HPN, YI-Lab
Activity 2.3.3a: Five-day residential training to fellows and municipal representatives													HPN, YI-Lab, NAAMII
Activity 2.3.3b: Digital literacy sessions led by Innovation Fellows in Partnered Municipalities													HPN

Output 3.1: Engagement in digital dialogues, knowledge generation, and advocacy strengthened among youth to influence communities, especially women, marginalized groups, and disadvantaged CBOs.													
Activity 3.1.1: Policy Dialogues on Digital Transformation and Youth Issues in Partnered Municipalities													HPN
Activity 3.1.2: Dissemination of AI, Coding, Animation, and Agri-Tech courses to School													HPN
Activity 3.1.3: Innovation Hubs establishment													HPN
Activity 3.1.4: “Innovation Unplugged” Podcast													YI-Lab
Activity 3.1.5: Creator’s Carnival													YI-Lab

For the following years:							
Activity	Half-year 3	4	5	6	7	8	Implementing body
	M 13-18	M 19-24	M 25-30	M 31-36	M 37-42	M 43-48	
1. Staff recruitment and orientation							
2. Orientation to the Project Team members covering both the program and finance aspect							YI-Lab
3. Meetings							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
3.1 PAT meeting							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
3.2 Monthly Project Implementation Team's meeting							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
3.3 Semi-annual/Annual review meeting							
4.1 Annual Interim Report (narrative and financial) to the EU							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
4.2 Final Report (narrative and financial) to the EU							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
5. Monitoring Visit							YI-Lab, HPN
6. Project Audit							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
7. SWC Evaluation							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
8. External Monitoring and Evaluation							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
9. Expenditure Verification							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA
Output 1.1: Digital skills and knowledge strengthened among young women and men, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs.							
AI School, Animation School, and Coding School							NAAMII, WIA, YI-Lab
Output 1.2: Access to digital tools, platforms, and resources improved for youth, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs.							
Activity 1.2.1: Delivery of Online Courses on AI, Coding, Animation, Cybersecurity, Digital Rights, and Entrepreneurship via Shikshya.org							YI-Lab, HPN, NAAMII, WIA

Output 2.1: Mechanisms for entrepreneurship development and mentorship support established for young people and CBOs.							
Activity 2.1.1: Entrepreneurial Bootcamps Supporting Youth-and Women-Led Enterprises							YI-Lab, HPN
Activity 2.1.2: Incubation and Mentorship for Social and Tech-Driven Enterprises							YI-Lab
Output 2.2: Youth-led digital innovations co-created to address challenges in public and private sectors.							
Activity 2.2.1: Organization of Hackathons on Public and Private Sector Challenges							YI-Lab, NAAMII
Output 2.3: Opportunities for professional experience created for young women and men at federal, provincial, and municipal levels.							
Activity 2.3.1: Internship and fellowship in the private sector							NAAMII
Activity 2.3.3: Municipal Innovation Fellowship for Establishing Local Innovation Hubs							HPN, YI-Lab
Activity 2.3.3a: Five-day residential training to fellows and municipal representatives							HPN, YI-Lab, NAAMII
Activity 2.3.3b: Digital literacy sessions led by Innovation Fellows in Partnered Municipalities							HPN, YI-Lab, NAAMII
Output 3.1: Engagement in digital dialogues, knowledge generation, and advocacy strengthened among youth to influence communities, especially women, marginalized groups, and disadvantaged CBOs.							
Activity 3.1.1: Policy Dialogues on Digital Transformation and Youth Issues in Partnered Municipalities							HPN, YI-Lab
Activity 3.1.2: Dissemination of AI, Coding, Animation, and Agri-Tech courses to School							HPN
Activity 3.1.3: Innovation Hubs establishment							HPN
Activity 3.1.4: “Innovation Unplugged” Podcast							YI-Lab
Activity 3.1.5: Creator’s Carnival							YI-Lab

2.1.4. Sustainability of the action (max 3 pages)

i. Expected long-lasting benefits of the action on its target

The action is designed to generate sustained impacts at the technical, economic, social, and policy levels by equipping young women and men with digital skills, employability pathways, and entrepreneurial opportunities. By embedding youth-led innovation, institutional capacity building, and inclusive digital governance into Nepal's development landscape, the action will ensure that young people and communities are able to participate equitably and sustainably in the digital world and job market.

Technical Benefits: More than 40,000 young women and men will acquire market-relevant digital competencies in AI, coding, animation, cybersecurity, and digital rights—skills that will remain valuable throughout their careers in Nepal's evolving economy. *Pathshala*'s tiered training will continue serving learners after the project period, offering ongoing access to digital education and job-matching services. Municipal Innovation Labs established in 14 municipalities will remain as hubs for youth and government officials to access technology and innovation resources.

Economic Benefits: More than 420 youth-led enterprises supported through hackathons, bootcamps, and incubation will generate self-employment and create jobs, while over 800 internships and fellowships will establish pipelines linking young people to diverse sectors of the economy. Work experience gained during these placements will increase youth competitiveness in the labor market, while 30% of the participants are expected to secure permanent employment or start their own businesses during the project. Innovation hubs and annual flagship events like the Creator's Carnival will build ecosystems that continue attracting investment, mentorship, and entrepreneurial activity long after the action concludes.

Social Benefits: By prioritizing participation of marginalized youth, women, and indigenous communities, the action will foster social inclusion, narrow the rural–urban divide, and strengthen civic engagement. At least 40% of participants will be women, reached through gender-responsive outreach and training, directly contributing to closing Nepal's digital gender gap. Fellows, interns, and youth innovators will form alumni networks for peer-support systems and knowledge-sharing. The innovation labs at municipalities will also create space for continued support to rural youth and engagement of cooperatives.

Policy and Institutional Benefits: Together, the four components of the action- *Pathshala, Karyashala, Karmashala*, and *Nitishala* will institutionalize innovation hubs within municipal structures, develop SOPs, and integrate digital literacy and emerging technologies into local curricula, influencing long-term education and governance practices. Collectively, these outcomes will strengthen Nepal's digital ecosystem, ensuring that young people, institutions, and governments continue to benefit from improved systems and practices.

ii. Detailed risk analysis and contingency plan.

Proposed Action	Identified Risk	Contingency Plan
Pathshala – Digital Skills Development (AI, Coding, Animation, Cybersecurity, Digital Rights)	**Physical:** Limited ICT infrastructure (poor internet, electricity outages) may restrict access to e-learning platforms. **Environmental:** Weather disruptions (monsoon, floods, landslides) may delay in-person trainings. **Social:** Gender and social barriers may limit participation of women, indigenous, and marginalized youth.	Upgrade Shikshya.org with low-bandwidth, offline features, and mobile optimization; distribute offline training kits (USBs, manuals). Adopt flexible scheduling around seasonal disruptions and shift sessions online when required. Implement targeted interventions, and outreach to ensure at least 40% women's participation.
Karyashala – Innovation and Entrepreneurship (Hackathons, Bootcamps, Incubation)	**Physical:** Limited availability of incubation space for youth-led enterprises. **Political:** Upcoming elections and volatile political situation may disrupt events. **Economic:** Limited sustainable investment for young enterprises may hinder long-term growth. **Social:** Youth from rural and marginalized areas may face barriers to attending events.	Organize hybrid/virtual hackathons and bootcamps; reschedule or relocate events during unrest or disasters. Align activity calendar with election cycles. Diversify sectoral partnerships and link enterprises with cooperatives to leverage their network and space, banks, and accelerators for sustainable financing. Provide travel subsidies and organize regional events to enhance participation of rural and

		marginalized youth.
Karmashala – Internships, Fellowships	**Physical:** Distance between mentors and mentees may reduce engagement. **Environmental:** Weather disruptions may delay in-person training and fellowship fieldwork. **Political:** Change in municipal leadership may affect Innovation Fellowship and hub operations. **Economic:** Limited job absorption by host organizations may reduce employability outcomes. **Social:** Marginalized youth may have unequal access to internships and fellowships.	Sign MoUs with municipalities to safeguard continuity despite political changes. Expand the pool of host organizations across private sector, academia, and cooperatives. Run targeted outreach in remote areas and among marginalized groups to ensure equitable participation. Provide digital tools to strengthen mentor–mentee relationships.
Nitishala – Policy, Institutionalization, and Advocacy (Innovation Hubs, Policy Dialogues, Curriculum Integration, Digital Literacy for Officials)	**Physical:** Lack of permanent incubation/innovation space in some municipalities. **Environmental:** Extreme weather may delay policy workshops and dialogues. **Political:** Weak municipal/provincial ownership, limited budget allocations, and election instability may undermine hubs. **Economic:** Municipalities may lack resources to sustain hubs post-project. **Social:** Resistance from officials to youth participation in policy processes.	Secure space through partnerships with local colleges, cooperatives, FNCCI, and municipal facilities. Use flexible scheduling and hybrid approaches for workshops. Build municipal ownership through training, advocacy, and joint implementation; push for municipal budget lines to sustain hubs. Link hubs with academic and cooperative networks to ensure continuity.
Cross-Cutting – Project Management, EU Visibility, Financial Oversight	**Political:** Political unrest, protests, or elections may disrupt project timelines. **Economic:** Exchange rate fluctuations or delayed fund disbursements may affect financial flows. **Physical/Environmental:** Pandemics or disasters may restrict mobility and gatherings. **Social/Reputational:** Non-compliance with EU visibility guidelines may undermine credibility.	Develop a contingency activity calendar considering elections and unrest and maintain neutrality. Conduct quarterly financial reviews, keep contingency budget lines, and maintain consortium reserves. Shift activities online during pandemics/disasters; ensure staff safety and insurance coverage. Implement a robust EU Communication & Visibility Plan with a dedicated communications officer, graphic designer, and video editor to ensure compliance

iii. Possibilities for multiplier effects

The action is designed with scalability and replication at its core, ensuring benefits extend far beyond direct interventions. Open-access platforms like Shikshya.org will remain available after the project, enabling wider access to digital courses and job-matching tools. The fellowship model is adaptable across sectors, embedding young women and men in institutions to transfer technical capacity while gaining experiential learning. High-visibility events such as the Creator's Carnival and Innovation Unplugged podcast will showcase youth-led innovations, while SOPs and policy briefs will provide practical models for replication by municipalities, NGOs, and other actors. Alignment with national priorities creates strong potential for government uptake, including integration of coding and AI into the national curriculum. At the community level, innovation labs and empowered youth will catalyze IT literacy camps, cooperative digitalization, and peer-to-peer learning, while regionally and globally, knowledge will be shared through EU platforms and Heifer International's networks. The Tangible platform further amplifies these effects by serving as Nepal's core digital skills infrastructure, bridging education with industry, startups, and e-governance, while its adaptability across South Asia, integration with 50+ international research institutions, open-source features,

and global licensing potential position it as a replicable model for AI education worldwide. Collectively, these features ensure that UDAAN's impact multiplies across institutions, communities, and countries.

iv. Sustainability after completion

The action is designed with long-term sustainability at its core, embedding ownership at municipal, institutional, and community levels. It also strengthens digital platforms and networks to ensure continued impact beyond the project's duration. Sustainability is addressed across four key dimensions:

a. **Financial Sustainability**: To ensure financial continuity, selected youth-led enterprises and innovations will receive seed funding, mentorship, and connections to financial institutions, enabling them to evolve into self-sustaining ventures. Municipal Innovation Hubs will be co-financed through formal agreements with local governments, which will allocate dedicated budget lines for operational costs such as equipment, internet access, and staffing. Courses on AI, animation, coding, and cyber safety, hosted on Shikshya.org, will be sustained through low-cost, scalable delivery models. By the end of the project, cost-effective approaches for hubs, schools, and training programs will be documented and demonstrated, enabling municipalities and relevant stakeholders to support them independently.

b. **Institutional Sustainability**: Innovation Hubs embedded within municipal governments will operate under established SOPs and be staffed with trained personnel, ensuring their integration into routine municipal functions. The AI, Coding, and Animation Schools will remain part of the e-learning ecosystem via Shikshya.org, with trained educators continuing to deliver content as part of their professional roles. Curriculum integration will institutionalize digital literacy and emerging technologies within mainstream education at both school and university levels. At the national level, consortium partners will advocate for institutionalizing successful models, such as embedding the fellowship approach for capacity transfer and strengthening municipal innovation committees to oversee ongoing youth–digital initiatives. Each consortium partner will also enhance its own institutional expertise, YI-Lab through civic tech and policy dialogue, HPN through community innovation, and NAAMII and WIA through youth engagement in AI and animation, ensuring long-term capacity to support municipalities and communities.

c. **Policy Sustainability:** The action will foster a more enabling policy environment for youth and digital development. Municipal policy dialogues and fellowship placements will result in youth-responsive and pro-digital policies, including strategies for sustaining Innovation Hubs and digital training programs. At the national level, UDAAN aligns with and reinforces the Digital Nepal Framework, Startup Policy (2024), and Youth Vision 2025, while also generating evidence to inform revisions of the National Youth Policy. The Tangible Careers platform will serve as a foundation for a national digital skills strategy, offering competency frameworks aligned with international standards and tailored to Nepal's context. Policy briefs and recommendations developed through the project will guide the scaling of Innovation Hubs, integration of digital literacy for officials, and mainstreaming of digital rights and GDPR-aligned data protection norms, embedding secure and inclusive digital governance practices.

d. **Environmental Sustainability:** UDAAN integrates environmental considerations throughout its design, ensuring positive impacts while minimizing ecological footprints. A Greening Matrix will be monitored throughout the project to assess the environmental impact of activities. Hackathons and bootcamps will feature innovation challenges focused on climate-smart agriculture, renewable energy, and waste management, empowering youth to develop solutions with tangible environmental benefits. Operationally, hybrid and digital learning models will reduce travel and printing, thereby lowering carbon emissions. By embedding environmental awareness into both curricula and institutional practices, the project ensures that communities remain digitally empowered and environmentally conscious well beyond its completion.

2.1.5. Logical Framework

Annex C

2.1.6. Budget, amount requested from the contracting authority and other expected sources of funding

Annex B

2.2. Experience

(i) Experience in similar actions in the past 3 years (Maximum 1 page per action)

Name of the organisation: **Lead applicant** √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Nepali Yuwa in Climate Action and Green Growth			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 111-education, level unspecified, 151-Government and civil society, general, 700-diaster preparedness		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)[20]**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal (Madhesh, Karnali, Sudurpashchim provinces)	569,684.44	Coordinator (Lead)	European Union	512,716.00	01/01/2022 – 31/12/2025
Objectives and results of the action	**Objectives:** Increased participation of Nepali youth in governance, entrepreneurship and advocacy in climate action in Madhesh, Karnali, and Sudurpaschim provinces **Results**: (1) Embedded 41 young professionals in three provincial ministries and 37 municipalities, gaining hands-on experience in local governance with a focus on DRRM. (2) Provided technical support to develop SOPs for the BIPAD Portal and Local Disaster & Climate Resilience Plans (LDCRPs); 13 SOPs and 11 LDCRPs have been formally endorsed. (3) Collected 5,659 data points on critical infrastructure and integrated them into the BIPAD Portal to strengthen risk-informed decision-making. (4) Mentored 90+ aspiring entrepreneurs and provided seed funding to 18 enterprises, of which 17 are now formally registered. (5) Engaged 3,798 youth through the TagMe digital campaign, contributing to the mapping of 8,508 waste and landslide data points. (6) Supported the formation of the 1st and 2nd cohorts of the Youth Sounding Board, amplifying youth voices in policy dialogue.			

[20] If the donor is the European Union or an EU Member State, please specify the EU budget line, EDF or EU Member State

Name of the organisation: Youth Innovation Lab

Lead applicant √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**

Project title: Advancing Agri-tech and Climate Innovation in Nepal (GRAPE II)			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 31181 – Agricultural education/training, 16020 – Employment creation		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Koshi, Karnali, and Sudurpashchim	93,500.00	Co-beneficiary	GIZ Nepal	93,500.00	15/09/2025 to 14/05/2027

Objectives and results of the action	**Objective:** The project aims to promote climate-smart agriculture and inclusive innovation in Nepal's most climate-vulnerable provinces (Koshi, Karnali, Sudurpashchim) by embedding trained youth fellows in municipalities, strengthening local governance, and empowering youth-led enterprises. The action fosters digital learning and entrepreneurship by developing modular e-learning courses on Shikshya.org, mentoring youth enterprises through bootcamps, and equipping local governments with climate-smart datasets, map books, and action plans. As the lead implementer, YI-Lab integrates youth, technology, and innovation to drive locally rooted climate resilience and economic opportunities. **Result: YI-Lab has been working on** 1. Deployment of Climate and Agri-Tech Fellows - 9 fellows recruited and placed in municipalities and provincial ministries to support climate-smart agricultural planning, vulnerability mapping, and digitization of agricultural datasets. 2. Entrepreneurship Support - Call for applications launched for youth-led enterprises; preparatory steps underway for 4 provincial bootcamps and 12 Entrepreneur's Adda sessions across the three provinces. 3. E-learning Content Development - Two modular e-learning courses on climate-smart agriculture and agri-innovation under development for integration into Shikshya.org, expected to reach 12,000 learners nationwide. 4. Digital Knowledge Tools - Design of municipal map books and climate-smart action plans initiated to improve local planning and informed decision-making. 5. Community Outreach - Early outreach and promotion campaigns launched to ensure inclusive participation, targeting women, Dalits, Janajatis, and marginalized youth in all activities.

Name of the organisation: Youth Innovation Lab **Lead applicant** √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Business Incubation for strengthened local agri-food systems in Karnali			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 31181 – Agricultural education/training, 16020 – Employment creation		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal, Surkhet and Dailekh District	182,565.00	Coordinator	GIZ/WHH	182,565.00	01/12/2023 – 31/10/2024
Objectives and results of the action		**Objective:** Support smallholder farmers and agri-intermediaries in Karnali Province improve their livelihoods by developing into "ecopreneurs" through: (1) Capacity building in entrepreneurship, business planning, and financial management, (2) Access to bootcamps, mentorship, online courses, and digital platforms, and (3) Strengthening of market linkages and value chains for sustainable, climate-resilient, and inclusive agri-businesses **Result:** (1) Launch of digital platforms (merokheti.org and Agri-Entrepreneurship 1.0 course) with 468 learners, ensuring wider access to agri-business knowledge. (2) 300 farmers and 40 intermediaries trained as ecopreneurs, gaining entrepreneurial, financial, and business management skills. (3) Strengthened market linkages through an Agri-Business Exhibition (39 stalls, 250+ stakeholders, 300+ visitors), fostering partnerships with cooperatives, FNCCI, and government. (4) Tangible business growth: 43 business plans implemented, 20 expansions, 13 registrations, 10 loans/subsidies accessed, and 31 using social media for marketing. (5) Enhanced inclusivity and sustainability: ~50% women, 27.65% minority/Dalit participation, and adoption of climate-smart, organic, and eco-friendly farming practices benefiting ~1,000 indirect individuals.			

Name of the organisation: Youth Innovation Lab **Lead applicant** √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: United States Embassy Youth Council (USYC) 2024, 2025			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 111-education, level unspecified		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	68,002.40	Coordinator	The U.S. Embassy	68,002.40	01/10/2024 – 31/12/2025
Nepal	63,748.00	Coordinator	The U.S. Embassy	63,748.00	02/10/2023 – 31/12/2024
Objectives and results of the action		**Objective: Empower youth from all 77 districts through transparent selection, capacity building, alumni mentorship, and a digital Opportunity Portal to drive civic leadership, innovation, and U.S.–Nepal collaboration.** **Results:** 2024: Selected 55 members from 1,570 applications through a transparent process and built their capacity via orientation, Chautari, and knowledge-sharing sessions. Implemented five nationwide youth-led Community Engagement Projects reaching thousands, engaged alumni as mentors and reviewers, digitized alumni profiles, and initiated the Opportunity Portal with a Digital Profile & Impact Book. 2025 (ongoing): Selected 55 youth leaders through nationwide outreach and are strengthening their capacity through orientation, monthly Chautari sessions, and targeted skill-building workshops. They will be implementing Impact and Engagement Projects under three thematic pillars, engaging in structured alumni mentorship, and utilizing the Opportunity Portal for collaboration and impact sharing.			

Name of the organisation: NAAMII **Lead applicant** **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Annual Nepal AI School			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 11120 – Education facilities and training		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	100,000	Coordinator	UKAID	100,000	Oct-19 - Ongoing
Objectives and results of the action	The NAAMII AI School aims to build core and advanced competencies in artificial intelligence by combining intensive lectures, labs, and mentored projects. It connects participants with leading international researchers, fostering exposure to global best practices and collaboration across borders. The program also seeks to establish a sustainable community of AI practitioners in Nepal who continue to share knowledge, datasets, and opportunities beyond the school. As a result, participants emerge with practical skills, research readiness, and industry awareness, often producing publishable project outputs or prototypes. Over time, alumni go on to secure research positions, internships, or AI jobs, contributing to Nepal's growing role as a regional hub for artificial intelligence.				

Name of the organisation: Heifer Project Nepal

Lead applicant **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**

Project title: Bridging the Gender Digital Gap in Nepal			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 31110 - Agricultural Development, 31161 – Food Crop Production, 31181 - Agriculture Education/Training		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	960,000	Coordinator	USAID and Pathway Technology	USAID: 480,000 Pathway: 480,000	17/05/2021 to 16/03/2023

Objectives and results of the action	**Objective 1:** To provide access to agriculture-extension and advisory services to 1 million women farmers. Results: A total of 1,097,071 farmers have been provided with agriculture-extension and advisory service through their engagement and training in E-Chautaris and GeoKrishi mobile application. Of the total farmers engaged, 82% were women. Established 387 E-Chautaris at the municipality offices (129) and cooperatives (238). A total of 1,307 Digital Agriculture Facilitators (DAFs) were trained and mobilized to accomplish the farmer outreach and training campaign. **Objective 2:** To customize the GeoKrishi platform with curated content/advisories to serve the needs of farmers. Results: Profiles of 45 common agricultural plants including crops, vegetables, fruits, and spices and 7 agricultural animals developed. Based on farmers' feedback, for enhancing their learning and user experience, GeoKrishi Farm application customized to include provision for audio and visual interactions. **Objective 3:** To ensure local government and private sector use digital data from GeoKrishi platform to prepare development plans, enhance extension service, and plan input and output market services with a focus on women farmers. Results: The municipality and cooperative based E-Chautaris provided with the GeoKrishi Enterprise web platform with functionalities of - map analytics to monitor the geographical distribution of the registered farmers; production plan database of farmers; soil test result of the farms; crop wise historic market data for price analysis and forecast; business plan preparation for crops; agriculture advisory on weather, seed, crop scheduling, crop calendar, livestock health, etc. Established formal collaboration with 4 regional market center authorities in Pokhara, Butwal, Dang and Surkhet cities. Online marketing platform called Samuhik Bazar developed. More than 400 entries of about 40 crops harvested amounting to more than 600 metric tons of produce, were made in the system.

Name of the organisation: WIA **Lead applicant** **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Data for Development Program Phase 2			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 11120 – Education facilities and training		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	1,60,527.10	Coordinator	The Asia Foundation	1,60,527.10	06/02/2024-10/03/2025
Objectives and results of the action	**Objective:** Bridge the gender gap in tech by removing financial barriers, providing education, mentorship, and industry exposure. **Result:** Total Trained student:195 female, 5 LGBTQI Students developed technical and creative expertise, built professional portfolios, and received course completion certificates.				

(ii) Experience in other actions in the past 3 years (Max. 1 page per action and max. 10 actions)

Name of the organisation: Youth Innovation Lab **Lead applicant** √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: RAIN-Resilience, Adaptation and Inclusion in Nepal			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 111-education, level unspecified, 151-Government and civil society, general, 700-diaster preparedness		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal (Madhesh Province)	98,940.95	Co-beneficiary	Foreign Commonwealth Development Office (FCDO)	98,317.60	01/05/2025 – 31/03/2026
Objectives and results of the action	**Objective:** RAIN+ aims to strengthen community-led, inclusive resilience by improving multi-hazard early warning, early action, and adaptation, while empowering CBOs and sub-national governments to use fiscal resources effectively. As a consortium partner, YI-Lab leads digital innovation by localizing the BIPAD platform, advancing inclusive risk communication (art, tech, youth), and providing technical support to GoN for data-driven resilience. **Results**: As the action is currently on-going, YI-Lab has been working on 1. Developed low-cost heat sensors that generate real-time data on temperature, humidity, and atmospheric pressure and successfully tested the performances of the sensors. 2. Developing heat and flood mural in selected municipalities of Madhesh province through participatory process engaging community members to communicate risk at the municipal level. 3. Working on the core strengthening of Bipad Portal in close coordination of NDRRMA. 4. Will be working with partnered municipality to orient them on Bipad Portal and use of data for informed decision making.				

Name of the organisation: Youth Innovation Lab **Lead applicant** √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Enhancing Media and Information Literacy (MIL) Across Nepal's Youth Organizations			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 15153 – Media and Free Flow of Information		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	11,864.53	Co-beneficiary	UNESCO	11,864.53	31/12/2024 – 30/05/2025
Objectives and results of the action		**Objective:** Enhance youth-led organizations' capacity to design and implement inclusive, evidence-based MIL programs, embed MIL in their operations, and contribute insights to shape Nepal's national MIL strategy in line with policy and global frameworks. **Results:** (1) Bilingual MIL Curriculum & Guidelines: Developed an English and Nepali MIL curriculum and a self-assessment tool to help youth organizations integrate MIL into their operations. (2) Workshops for 25 Organizations: Delivered interactive workshops with measurable improvements in MIL understanding, fact-checking skills, ethical content creation, and digital safety. (3) Organizational Action Plans: Over six organizations created and started implementing MIL action plans, with all cascading knowledge through internal sessions. (4) Enhanced MIL Competencies: Participants gained foundational AI literacy and critical perspectives on misinformation, disinformation, and mal information. (5) National Strategy Contribution: Produced evidence-based recommendations to inform Nepal's National MIL Strategy, extending impact beyond direct participants.			

Name of the organisation: Youth Innovation Lab **Lead applicant** √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Protecting Online Rights of Changemakers (PORCH)			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 15153 – Media and Free Flow of Information		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Bangladesh, India, Nepal, Sir-Lanka	68,063.90	Co-beneficiary	Internews funded by U.S. Department of State	68063.90	25/10/2023 - 25/04/2025
Objectives and results of the action	**Objective:** Empower youth and women by raising awareness on digital human rights and creating safe, collaborative spaces to advocate for inclusive digital policies. YI-Lab leads the e-learning course development and ToT program to build a national network of trainers. **Results:** Although the project was suspended due to the Executive Order, YI-Lab continued key activities through institutional support and achieved the following: 1. Developed and published a five-module course, Digital Rights: Understanding Your Online Freedoms, with expert input from an editorial board; now available on Shikshya.org. 2. Launched a nationwide digital campaign to engage with the youth and disseminate about the courses. 3. Enrolled 233 learners who are actively participating in the course.				

Name of the organisation: Youth Innovation Lab **Lead applicant** √ **Co-applicant** **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: RiskChanges Development Project			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 74020 - multi-hazard response preparedness		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Case study location: Nepal, Caribbean, Europe	29,767.40	Co-beneficiary	Asian Institute of Technology	29,767.40	01/05/2024 to 30/04/2025
Objectives and results of the action	**Objective:** Develop an interactive platform that integrates hazard, exposure, vulnerability, and elements at risk to visualize, compare, and analyze changing risks across scenarios, enabling evidence-based planning and risk reduction. **Results:** (1) A fully functional RiskChanges platform with user-friendly UI for scenario creation, visualization, and risk comparison. (2) Interactive visual tools (maps, charts, and summary panels) that clearly show changes in risk across scenarios and alternatives. (3) Successful migration of existing datasets into a standardized schema, ensuring continuity and accuracy of past analyses. (4) A comprehensive training manual and walkthroughs that enable non-technical users to confidently use the platform. (5) Improved decision-making capacity among stakeholders through accessible, evidence-driven insights. (6) Established quality assurance framework with tested workflows, ensuring system reliability, security, and scalability. (7) Increased awareness and adoption of risk-informed planning practices by governments, organizations, and communities.				

Name of the organisation: Heifer Project Nepal **Lead applicant** **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Strengthening Smallholder Enterprises of Livestock Value Chain for Poverty Reduction and Economic Growth in Nepal (SLVC II)			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 31120 – Agricultural Development, 31163 – Livestock		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	10,548,523	Coordinator	Heifer International	10,548,523	01/04/2018 to 30/06/2023
Objectives and results of the action					

Objective 1: Strengthen farmers' organizations. Results: Enhanced 6,855 women-led self-help groups and 178 cooperatives, benefiting around 140,000 rural farmers. Institutional and business capacities of cooperatives improved. >100 cooperatives adopted software-based financial management system. Cooperatives doubled their governance and operational capacities, resulting in a 160% increase in profitability.

Objective 2: Supply chain efficiency of the targeted value chains. Results: Input volumes marketed by cooperatives quintupled. Meat goat sales increased by 143%, while milk and dairy products sales grew by 278%. Agri-product sales also rose significantly from 198,959 to 262,698 tonnes annually. Farm profitability improved by 76%, while productivity for meat goats and dairy animals rose by 87% and 86%, respectively.

Objective 3: Economic opportunities and resources leverage for farmers. Results: Enhanced access to finance for cooperatives and MSMEs: 3,292 farmers received loans of USD 9.6 million; 83 cooperatives received USD 5.6 million in wholesale loans; 9 cooperatives received USD 1.4 million for working capital.

Objective 4: Improve the enabling environment for the target value chains. Results: Farmers' agri-business functions and market behavior changed. Increased women's entrepreneurship in rural communities. Effective market linkages of VC products and services established. >700 market infrastructures developed in rural areas in partnership with local governments. Market resilience increased for targeted VC commodities.

Overall, household income increased by 54%. Notably, 53.2% households achieved living incomes. Employment in target value chains doubled, creating an additional 68,665 jobs annually.

Name of the organisation: Heifer Project Nepal

Lead applicant **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**

Project title: Value Chains for Inclusive Transformation of Agriculture Programme (VITA)			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 31110 - Agricultural Development, 31161 – Food Crop Production		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	18,417,790	Coordinator	Heifer International and the Government of Nepal (GoN)	Heifer International: 7,952,674 GoN: 10,456,116	17/06/2022 to 30/06/2028
Objectives and results of the action					

Objective 1: Improve smallholder producers and their organizations' capacities to run profitable farm enterprises and establish linkages with suppliers and buyers. Results: Enhanced institutional capacities of 1187 self-help groups (SHGs) and 32 cooperatives in terms of good governance, prudent financial management, and increasing business volume.

Objective 2: Transformational increase in investment in the smallholder agricultural sectors. Results: Linked entrepreneurs and cooperatives with banks and financial institutions for accessing loans based on their business. A total of USD 320,000 loan disbursed to 79 Smallholder Farmers to expand their farm businesses.

Objective 3: Improve access to market system infrastructure. Results: Cooperatives and SHGs started collective marketing and built functional relationships with traders. Physical market infrastructures such as collection and processing centres, cold storage, etc. developed in partnership with local governments.

Objective 4: Enabling environment for target value chains improved. Results: Sales-based subsidy mechanism for milk and spice crops contributed to scaling up of business volume due to farmers motivating to increase quality and quantity of production. Development and promotion of barren land utilization policies at the local level boosted local food production and income diversification, contributing to rural revitalization.

Name of the organisation: Heifer Project Nepal **Lead applicant** **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Innovations in Agriculture and Livestock Value Chain Development (IALVC)			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 31110 - Agricultural Development, 31163 – Livestock		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	11,498,341	Coordinator	Heifer International and GoN	Heifer International: 8,358,806 GoN: 3,139,535	01/04/2023 to 31/03/2027
Objectives and results of the action					

Objective 1: Improve productivity through increased capacity of smallholder farmers and better access to production technologies. **Results:** Smallholder farmers organized into groups and enrolled in Farmers Business School (FBS), to motivate them to transform their production system into a market driven. This resulted in increased vegetable production area by 0.5 to 3 times and better prices (2-3 times higher). Adoption of climate-resilient and regenerative practices, including the adoption of new seeds and technologies doubled productivity by 2-3 times.

Objective 2: Strengthen the capacity of cooperatives for effective supply chain management of selected value chains. **Results:** The total business turnover from active entities dealing with target commodities reached USD 80,000/cooperative/year. 193 cooperatives and 16 local governments extended partnerships. A total of USD 1.7 million bank loans disbursed to 1,857 smallholder farmers.

Objective 3: Market linkages and business relationship with private sectors. **Results:** Business deals made with international traders/buyers. More than 200+ retail shops, marts, and hotels linked and started sourcing turmeric, jaggery, ginger, and vegetables directly from the participating cooperatives.

Objective 4: Establish a Cooperative digital platform. **Results:** Developed components of the digital platform: GKS Farm, GKSExt, GKS Enterprise, and Samuhik Bazar. The GKS Agrovet functions integrated in GKSExt. Access to finance function developed and core banking system integrated in GKS. Digital record keeping of produce collection and transaction between farmers, cooperatives and processing centres developed.

Name of the organisation: NAAMII **Lead applicant** **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Amplify Change project			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR): 13020 – Reproductive Health Care**		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal	86,000.00	Coordinator	Amplify Change	86,000.00	Feb 2024 – Jan 2026
Objectives and results of the action	The Amplify Change project has focused on increasing youth awareness of Sexual and Reproductive Health (SRH) and abortion systems in Nepal. It has brought about a notable shift in perspectives by introducing innovative tools, including a chatbot and dedicated social media platforms, which are effectively informing young people about abortion policies and services.				

Name of the organisation: NAAMII **Lead applicant** **Co-applicant** √ **Affiliated entity**					
Project title: Data Collection for Third Party Ultrasound Partners			**Sector (ref. list of sectors in Sectorial experience in PADOR):** 13020 – Reproductive Health Care		
Location of the action	**Amount of the action (EUR)**	**Role: coordinator, co-beneficiary, affiliated entity**	**Donors to the action (name)**	**Amount contributed (by donor)**	**Dates** (from..to) dd/mm/yyyy
Nepal, Uganda, Kenya, Nigeria	512,000	Coordinator	Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation	512,000	Oct 2024 – Oct 2025
Objectives and results of the action	The Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation (BMGF) project is progressing strongly, with active collaboration among partners across diverse geographic regions, ensuring rich data collection and shared expertise. These partnerships have also fostered significant learning and capacity development, strengthening both technical and implementation outcomes.				